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NOTICE IS HEREBY GIVEN OF THE
27th ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING
OF
NORTHERN SETTLEMENT SERVICES LIMITED

TO BE HELD ON THURSDAY 24 NOVEMBER 2011
AT 8 CHAUCER STREET HAMILTON
AT 10.30am

1. OPENING & WELCOME
BY CHAIRMAN, MR HENRY CHAN OAM JP
2. APOLOGIES
3. MINUTES OF 2010 AGM
4. BUSINESS ARISING
5. PRESENTATION OF REPORTS
6. CONFIRMATION OF AUDITORS
7. ELECTION -NSS BOARD OF MANAGEMENT
8. GENERAL BUSINESS
9. LAUNCH OF **THE CULTURAL DIVERSITY & DEMENTIA IN THE
HUNTER & CENTRAL COAST RESEARCH REPORT**
10. CLOSE & LIGHT REFRESHMENTS

Board of Management - 30 June 2011

Mr Henry Chan OAM JP	Chairman
Mr William Simanowsky	Deputy Chairman
Ms Trudy Mills-Evers AM	Treasurer, Public Officer, Finance & Audit Committee
Ms Biko Syongoh	Assistant Treasurer, Finance & Audit Committee
Ms Sania Young	Secretary, Finance & Audit Committee
Ms Irina Lupish	Assistant Secretary
Ms Christine Jordan	Director
Fr Nicholas Zervas OAM	Director, Australia Day Committee
Ms Zoran Vasiljevic	Director
Ms Anna Marendy	Director
Ms Carla Silva	Director
Mr James Garvey	Director
Cr. Nuatali Nelmes	Co-opted Member, Newcastle City Council

Staff Summary – 30 June 2011

Chief Executive Officer / Special Project Team Leader	Violetta Walsh OAM*
Deputy CEO / Acting CEO/ Migration Agent	Lulu Tantos
Migration Agent	Olivia Fuente/Richard Hardy*
Financial Controller/Accounts Manager	Arlene Richards*/Marianne Mohr
Assistant to the Financial Controller/ Accounts Assistant	Marianne Mohr /Wendy Kirkham
Office Manager /Acting Operations Manager	Mary Milevski
Information & Referral: Reception Staff	Silvia Ruano-McLerie*, Helen Short*, Lydia Manusiu, Wendy Kirkham, Jacinta Boidin
OH&S Consultant	Helen Buchanan
Rural Projects Team Leader	Alex Burns
Hunter Welfare Outreach SGP	Rose Oku
New England SGP Worker (Tamworth)	Amalin Sundaravej
New England SGP Worker (Armidale)	Judith Roberts
New England SGP Worker (Inverell)	Katie Wright*
Central Coast Team Leader (office located at Bateau Bay)	Sandra Wingrave*/Alex Burns
Office Manager	Sharlene Huber
Office Administration	Julie Styles*/Marilyn Perez-Cabrera
Multicultural Social Support Service Coordinator	Olivia Fuente
Multicultural Social Support Service Coordinator	Anita Trainor
Multicultural Social Support Service Coordinator	Kellie Matterson
SGP Worker	Danielle Habib*
Multicultural Family Worker	Pari Batha/Natalia Meliendrez
Aged Services Team Leader / Community Aged Care Packages Coordinator	Sue Hristov
Community Aged Care Packages Coordinator	Lupe Fonua
Community Aged Care Packages Coordinator / Tax Help Officer	Tima 'Oto
Hunter Multicultural Respite Service Coordinator	Tima 'Oto
Community Visitors Scheme Coordinator	Enza Di Stefano
Multicultural Access Project Worker	Valerie Woodman
Refugee Support Team Leader / Complex Case Support Coordinator	Kiri Hata*
African Communities Worker -SGP	Flora Aine*/ Stephen Mawa Luka*
African Youth Worker -SGP	Tonkoh Kamara
Life Skills & Parenting Groups, Refugee Programs Project Officer	Helen Buchanan
Burundi Family Support Worker	Joselyne Ntahomvukiye
Congolese Family Support Worker	Kwabo Batende
African Parenting Assistant	Amer Manyun*
Volunteers Coordinator (Educational Programs)	Michael Freund
Volunteers Coordinator (Welfare Programs)	Georgina Ramsay
Welfare Team Leader / Filipino Welfare Worker	Petrona Kelly
Multicultural Family Worker (Families First)	Miza Torlakovic
Pacific Islander Welfare Worker (Samoan) / Tax Help Officer / EAPA	Juanita Loli
Pacific Islander Welfare Worker (Tongan)	Finau Manu
Russian Welfare Worker	Elena Ferguson
Thai Welfare Worker	Nellie Srisurapon
Brighter Futures Coordinator	Zenaida Edmunds
Parenting Support Project Officer	

**Indicates is no longer with the organisation, at time of print*

MINUTES OF 2010 ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING

THURSDAY 25 NOVEMBER 2010, 11.00AM.

MEMBERS OF NORTHERN SETTLEMENT SERVICES LIMITED

Minutes: Mary Milevski (Office Manager)

1. **ATTENDANCE:** as per lists
2. **APOLOGIES:** as per lists
3. **MINUTES for AGM 2009– Accepted**
Proposed: Fthr N Zervas
Seconded: CJordan
4. **BUSINESS ARISING:**
 - NSS has sponsored an annual 'Cultural Diversity' Award at TAFE. This year the award was awarded to two Mauritanian individuals who shared the award.
5. **PRESENTATION OF STAFF REPORTS:**

H Chan OAM - Chairman, NSS Board: Report tabled & accepted as read.

VWalsh OAM – Chief Executive Officer: Report tabled & accepted as read.

Special Projects:

LTantos, Deputy CEO, Registered Migration Agent: Report tabled & accepted as read

- Mentioned Olivia Fuente who is now working as a registered migration agent from NSS head office, three days a week.
- Acknowledged Irina Lupish for her work in mentor role
- Acknowledged work & support of Richard Hardy, registered migration agent

KHata, Complex Case Manager: Report tabled & accepted as read

- Acknowledged the work of two additional staff members (Nellie Srisurapon & Shakila Jokhia) who have supported the program & thanked them for their good work

ABurns, Rural Team Leader: Reports tabled & accepted as read

Central Coast Team: Reports tabled & accepted as read

- MSSS Coordinator Anita Trainor reported the Blue Haven Group has ben 'reborn' saying that interest in the group keeps growing & this was very inspiring for the group & project.
- ABurns noted the good work of SGP worker Danielle Habib & her receipt of Community Builders Award for "Best Individual Paid Employee".

SHristov, Aged Services Team Leader: Reports tabled & accepted as read

- Expressed her personal thanks to VWalsh for the 'opportunity to work at a great place', also mentioned her teams sincere appreciation for her support, guidance & friendship over the many years – saying she will be greatly missed!
- Val Woodman completed first year of project, mentioning that it has been a pleasure joining the NSS team.

KHata, Refugee Team Leader: Reports tabled & accepted as read

- Introduced new staff: Ater Dhiu (Youth, Sport & Recreation Officer), Mawa Luka (SGP), Kwabo Batende (Congolese Family Support).
- Noted Flora Aine has left on maternity leave
- Mentioned that the project formerly known as 'African Youth' is now 'CALD Youth Program'
- Thanked the Board & Management, on behalf of the team, for their support & said the team hope to continue to empower communities with their work
- Michael Freund, Volunteer Coordinator mentioned recent funding from DIAC allowed for additional staff for Homework Centres. He said that these continued to operate well & with much interest from students & volunteers.
- Penola House has established a driving support & training program utilising NSS volunteers & this has been a great achievement.
- Michael Freund expressed best wishes to Ron Davies of the recently disbanded CRS group & acknowledged the long standing collaborative relationship between the group & NSS.

PKelly, Welfare Team Leader: Reports tabled & accepted as read

- Thanked VWalsh & LTantos for their support & commitment to NSS.
- Nellie Srisurapon thanked VWalsh, the Administration team & Team Leaders for their support.
- Apologies for no photograph of Finau Manu & also thanked VWalsh for her dedication.

STAFF REPORTS – Accepted

Proposed: TMills-Evers

Seconded: SYoung

6. FINANCIAL REPORTS/CONFIRMATION OF AUDITORS:

- Glen Peterkin of Cutcher & Neale provided an overview of the annual reports. He mentioned the FBT refund from the ATO regarding the organisation's PBI status. He congratulated the NSS Board, Management & Finance Team for another excellent year of management & progress verified by NSS's healthy financial position. He expressed his best wishes on behalf of C&N, to VWalsh & ARichards.

Motion to accept financials & appoint Cutcher & Neale as Auditors for next financial year:

Proposed: TMills-Evers

Seconded: HChan

7. **ELECTION OF BOARD:**

11 vacancies for the Board

Nominations are:

- i. William Simanowsky
- ii. Trudy Mills-Evers
- iii. Sania Young
- iv. Fthr Nicholas Zervas
- v. Christine Jordan
- vi. Zoran Vasiljevic
- vii. Anna Marendy
- viii. James Garvey
- ix. Carla Silva
- x. Irina Lupish
- xi. Henry Chan

- **Cr Nuatali Nelmes – co-opted member (NCC)**

All Directors duly elected to the 2011 Board.

The Board elect agreed & moved:

- The close of NSS premises for the end of year break, from 23/12/2010 to 4/1/2011
- To purchase NSS Hamilton property. A subcommittee to be formed comprising of HChan, TMills-Evers, VWalsh, LTantos & JGarvey to work on refining the purchase & negotiate details of mortgage & renovations etc
- To hold the next meeting the hour before the Christmas Party, 16/12/2011

8. **GENERAL BUSINESS:**

- The office of Member for Newcastle Jodi McKay, has issued 15 tickets for 'African Youth' to attend local sporting event.
- The 2 properties of Everton Street Hamilton being managed by NSS, will be transferred to Compass Housing.
- Denise Hodgson, MSO Centrelink, acknowledged the service & contribution of VWalsh over her many years at MRC/NSS, saying that she will be missed personally & professionally.
- VWalsh mentioned the donations box at Newcastle Airport (Insomnia & Grappa) & thanked James Garvey for his initiative & support & the charitable arm which NSS hopes to expand on in the new year.
- TMills-Evers also acknowledged the contribution of James Garvey – his expertise, experience & the reputation he brings. HChan supported these comments & said he was very grateful that James had accepted nomination to continue with the Board in the future.
- HChan acknowledged the hard work of the Board, Management & Staff over the year & proposed a vote of best wishes to VWalsh

Meeting closed at 12.05pm

ATTENDANCE – AGM 25/11/2010

Name	Organisation
Lupe A Fonua	NSS
Sue Hristov	NSS CACP
Marianne Mohr	NSS Staff
Michael Todd	Macedonian Community
Olivia Fuente	NSS
Alex Burns	NSS
Violetta Walsh	NSS
Trudy Mills-Evers	NSS Board
Kiri Hata	NSS
Shakila Jokhia	NSS
Amer Manyon	NSS
Tonkoh Kamara	NSS
Biko Syongoh	NSS Board
Kwabo Batende	NSS
Paul Marendy	Hippocrates Association
Anna Marendy	Hippocrates Association/ NSS Board Member
Sania Young	NSS Board
Glen Peterkin	Cutcher & Neale (Audit)
Pari Batha	NSS
Anita Trainor	NSS Central Coast
Tima Oto	Tongan Community
Arlene Richards	NSS
Miza Torlakovic	NSS
Enza Di Stefano	NSS
Jacinta Boidin	NSS
Valerie Woodman	NSS
Wendy Kirkham	NSS
Lulu Tantos	NSS
Nellie Srisurapon	NSS
Joselyne Ntahomvukiye	NSS
Carla Silva	HNE Health NSS Board
Natalia Nelves	NCC
Mary Milevski	NSS
Denise Hodgson	Centrelink
Christine Jordan	NSS Board
Victor Lupish	Ethnic Choral Society
Father Nicholas Zervas	NSS Board
Elena Ferguson	NSS
Finau Manu	NSS
W. Simanowsky	NSS Board
Juanita Purcell Loli	NSS
Pet Kelly	NSS
Helen Short	NSS
Henry Chan	NSS Board
Lydia Manusia	NSS
Michael Freund	NSS
Irina Lupish	NSS Board

APOLOGIES – AGM 2010

NAME	ORGANISATION
Mana Manning	Estonian Group
Silvia Ruano McLerie	NSS
Helen Buchanan	NSS
Danielle Habib	NSS – CC
Julie Styles	NSS – CC
Lola Sklavos	NSS Member
Peter Sklavos	NSS Member
Zoran Vasiljevic	NSS Board
Zeni Edmunds	NSS
Georgina Ramsay	NSS
Richard Hardy	NSS

Overview of 2010 - 2011

Funding Partnerships

-  **Department of Immigration & Citizenship (DIAC)**
-  **Department of Human Services, Community Services Agency**
-  **Commonwealth Department of Health & Ageing**
-  **NSW Department of Ageing Disability & Home Care (DADHC)**
-  **Community Development Support Expenditure (Registered Clubs NSW)**
-  **Department of Families & Housing, Community Services & Indigenous Affairs (FaHCSIA)**

Our Supporters: Donations & Acknowledgements

-  **Insomnia Café, Newcastle Airport**
-  **Grappa Wine Bar, Newcastle Airport**
-  **Grill'd Burgers, The Junction - Local Matters**
-  **Alliance for Peace** *(donated a Bain Marie for African Women's Training Markets)*
-  **Westpac Banking Corporation** *(contributed to Refugee Week event 'Puppet Show')*

Networks & Interagencies

Northern Settlement Services supports a range of networks including the Mid North Coast, North Coast & Hunter Rural Multicultural Networks & the Central West, Central Coast, Newcastle & New England Multicultural Interagencies & the Hunter Refugee Network & the Hunter CALD Aged & Disability Services Network.



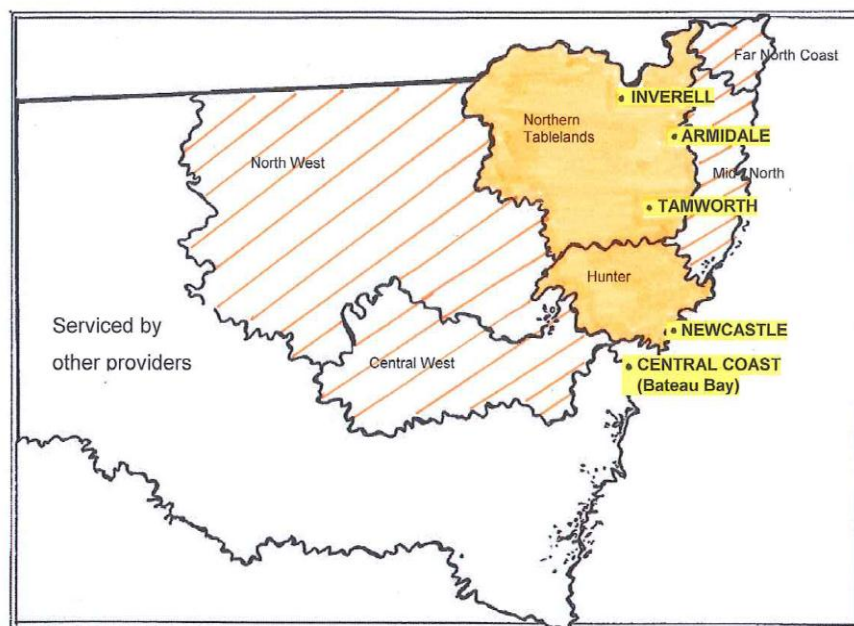
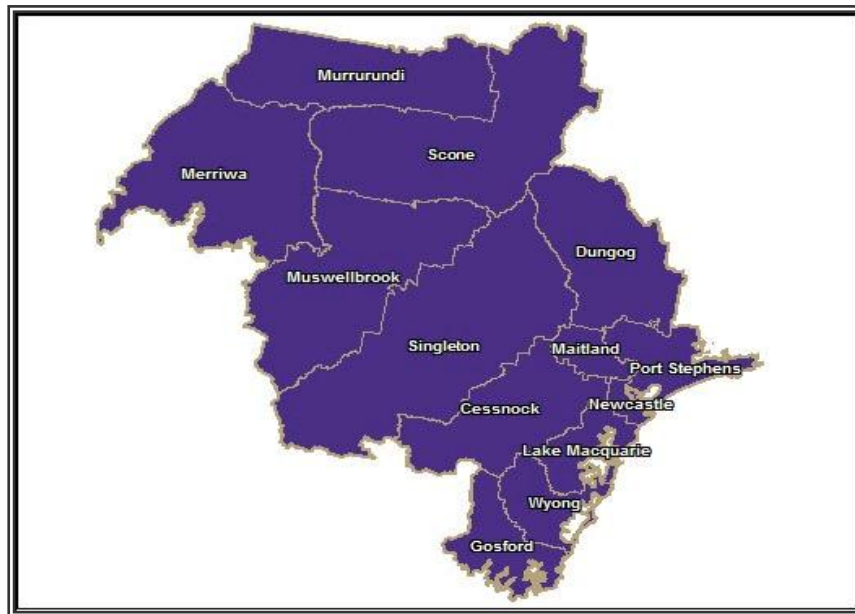
Our clients...

Clients by Ethnic Background and/or Birthplace

Afghanistan	Greece	North Sudan	Vietnam
Albania	Guatemala	Norway	Venezuela
Algeria	Guyana	Panama	Zimbabwe
Argentina	Honduras	Pakistan	
Armenia	Hungary	Papua New Guinea	
Australia	Hong Kong	Paraguay	
Austria	India	Peru	
Bangladesh	Indonesia	Poland	
Bosnia	Ireland	Portugal	
Botswana	Iran	Philippines	
Brazil	Iraq	Romania	
Burma	Israel	Russia	
Burundi	Italy	Rwanda	
Cambodia	Japan	Scotland	
Canada	Jordan	Senegal	
Chile	Kazakhstan	Serbia	
China	Kenya	Slovenia	
Colombia	Korea	Sierra Leone	
Congo (DRC)	Kuwait	Singapore	
Croatia	Laos	Somalia	
Cuba	Latvia	South Africa	
Cyprus	Lebanon	Sri Lanka	
Czech Republic	Liberia	South Sudan	
Dominican Republic	Lithuania	Spain	
East Timor	Macedonia	Sweden	
Egypt	Malaysia	Switzerland	
El Salvador	Malta	Syria	
England	Mauritania	Tahiti	
Ecuador	Mexico	Taiwan	
Eritrea	Montenegro	Thailand	
Ethiopia	Morocco	Tonga	
Fiji	Myanmar	Turkey	
Finland	Nepal	Uganda	
France	Netherlands	Ukraine	
Germany	New Zealand	Uruguay	
Ghana	Nigeria	USA	

OFFICE LOCATIONS & SERVICE REGIONS

HUNTER OUTREACH



Direct NSS service areas including Outreach locations



Other regions supported by NSS



Chairman's Report

Mr Henry Chan OAM

It only seems like yesterday that we celebrated our 25th anniversary and yet here we are today, 5 years on quietly marking our 30th year of existence in the Hunter Region, continuing to provide a comprehensive array of services and programmes for Culturally and Linguistically Diverse (CALD) and disadvantaged communities.

Established in Newcastle in 1981 with just 2 core staff, the organisation has grown into a multi-faceted service of our over 45 staff, approximately 200 volunteers and a geographical footprint which includes offices on the Central Coast, Tamworth and Armidale in the New England Region of New South Wales.

These achievements have been driven by our continuous mission to provide not only the best settlement services to our target population but also to create a social environment which engenders harmonious community relations, responsive mainstream service providers and a receptive and welcoming host community.

For 27 of these 30 years the guiding force behind these achievements has been our former CEO, Violetta Walsh OAM, who officially retired on 30 September 2011, with a remarkable record of dedicated service to the agency and its people, a true advocate for multicultural Australia.

Ironically it was also the year in which the Minister for Immigration and Citizenship launched "The People of Australia – Australia's Multicultural Policy", a historical moment for all in the multicultural sector, who like us at NSS have stood up for multiculturalism. For the Government, the policy acknowledges that "government services and programs must be responsive to the needs of our culturally diverse communities. It commits to an access and equity framework to ensure that the onus is on government to provide equitable services to Australians from all backgrounds".

The Board began the year by implementing the earlier agreement to purchase the building as a way of putting down permanent roots in the area where we have made our mark. The financial performance of the organisation has been good, ending the year with a strong balance sheet, despite the reduction in SGP funding and a general financial down turn due to the loss of IAAAS funding and a massive increase to workers compensation premiums. As we move ahead into some difficult and challenging times, I would like to take a moment to reflect on the tremendous work of the staff and volunteers of NSS. Their boundless passion and dedication to the organisation and the local community is absolute and it is precisely this devotion and perseverance that makes a difference to the daily lives of so many individuals; as ever my sincere thanks to our CEO, Lulu Tantos and senior staff for all their drive and commitment. To my fellow executive members, thank you for your friendship, wisdom and support in guiding and steering NSS over the last twelve months.

The friendships that have been made along the way in this journey that is NSS, I believe, have certainly enriched all our lives for the better and I extend my thanks to each and every one of you for your friendship and support over the previous year.



Chief Executive Officer's Report

Ms Lulu Tantos

Our clients come to us from all corners of the globe imagining a new life and new opportunities. Despite the hardships, they manage to harness their courage and inner sources of strength to rebuild their lives in completely new circumstances. For 30 years it has been the core business of NSS to work with individuals and communities, empowering them to reach their full potential. Our efforts over the last financial year again reflect the commitment we have made to our newly arrived communities, our longer settled aged communities, as well as to the local community in which we operate.

Our most recent refugee and humanitarian arrivals have been the Congolese community and I'm pleased to announce that we demonstrated the capacity to respond quickly and professionally to enable their settlement particularly in the Newcastle area.

Complacency certainly isn't a word which can be used to describe our past year. The entire NSS team should be acknowledged for their dedication and professionalism delivering services to our newly arrived communities. We are constantly developing innovative programs aimed at easing the transition for our new arrivals, particularly in key areas of employment, housing, financial management, community capacity building and self-development.

Our local interagency meetings are highly effective and very well represented, I would like to thank all members and their organisations for the excellent work they do and their continued support.

For me, the year has been one of great change and many challenges as I took over the reins of the organisation in January 2011 as Acting CEO from Violetta Walsh who after extended leave, retired on 30 September 2011. As our Chairman highlighted in his report, she has been the driving force of this organisation for 27 of its 30 years. A remarkable achievement for a remarkable woman, who has contributed so much to the local community, stood up for multiculturalism when it counted and yet sought very little in return!

The year began with the announcement by DIAC that our tender to provide Humanitarian Settlement Services was not successful. A disappointing blow to the region but nevertheless it did not stop us moving forward and focusing on what we do best, the core business of settling newly arrived migrants and refugees. As always my sincere gratitude and thanks to Alex Burns for submitting the SGP applications on time! A number of projects were applied for including the Rural SGP Projects, the continuation of the homework centres and a specialist housing project to provide targeted assistance to clients aimed at helping them source long – term accommodation in the region. While DIAC approved funding for our homework centres and Rural SGP projects, the amount of funding this year was well below that applied for which regrettably resulted in budget cuts across all the service delivery areas affected.

In addition to cuts made to existing SGP programs NSS was also unsuccessful in its tender to continue providing immigration advice under the Immigration Advice And Application Scheme (IAAAS).

On a positive note NSS as has since negotiated and entered into an agreement with one of the preferred tenderers, Playfair Visa and Migration Services based in Sydney, to undertake work throughout regional New South Wales on a fee for service basis. We welcome that partnership and the opportunity to provide a valuable service to vulnerable disadvantaged individuals in the community.

This dark cloud aside, our general mood is buoyant. We have been able to maintain the delivery of the suite of services that support the needs of our client groups and that is due to the fact that our funding, in particular the EIPP funding from Department of Human Services has not only continued to be stable but has been enhanced as has funding to our Brighter Futures Program. It is worth noting that this sort of success owes a great deal to our agency's governance and management. Our organisation is strong and stable, thanks to our wonderful Board, focussed and energetic, thanks to our great staff and in excellent financial state, thanks to our financial managers. The team managers continue to punch above their weight and provide sound supervision and support to the workers involved in their respective compatible programs, and in particular to those workers in our regional offices who often work in isolation to deliver their work programs, achieve client outcomes and represent the NSS name in their local communities. Thank you to Judith, Amalin and our Central Coast Team and to our army of volunteers that make it all possible.

Our Aged Services team continues to make a very positive impact for older CALD communities in the Hunter region. This year NSS received Home And Community Care (HACC) funds to undertake a CALD dementia research project specific to the Hunter and Central Coast region, the results of which will be launched today. Congratulations to Sue, Val and the team on a comprehensive year.

On another positive note I would like to congratulate the Board on its purchase of the property we have called home for over 25 years. Not only does it give us a sense of security but will provide a sound financial investment in years to come. A place in which we can consolidate our programs and set a positive course for the future, one in which we continue to grow, diversify and meet the changing needs of our community. I look forward to continuing the journey with all of you over the coming year.



Immigration Advice & Assistance Scheme

Lulu Tantos, Richard Hardy & Olivia Fuente

(Reg.#0318123)

(Reg.#9473161)

(Reg.#0801294)

Funded by Department of Immigration & Citizenship

Northern Settlement Services Ltd (NSS) continues to provide quality immigration advice and assistance to clients in Newcastle, the Hunter Region and its catchment area.

This year the service has been maintained and provided by CEO Lulu Tantos and Richard Hardy, who joined us on a contractual basis in October 2009 and whose contribution over the year has been truly valued. The service was further augmented by the arrival of a new worker, Olivia Fuente, from our Central Coast office, herself a registered migration agent, in November 2010. We welcome her to the team and look forward with her assistance to maintaining this valuable service at NSS.

As in previous years, the service has been provided to two distinct client groups:

- IAAAS (Immigration Advice & Application Assistance Scheme) eligible clients; and
- Fee paying clients

In the 2010-2011 financial year NSS was one of 23 DIAC (Department of Immigration and Citizenship) funded IAAAS providers around Australia providing professional assistance, free of charge, to the most vulnerable and needy visa applicants, to help with the completion and submission of visa applications, liaison with the department, and advice on complex immigration matters.

Persons eligible for Application Assistance include all protection visa applicants in detention, and the most disadvantaged protection visa applicants and other visa applicants in the community. Advice sessions are designed for disadvantaged visa applicants, prospective visa applicants or sponsors in the community.

What counts as disadvantage?

A 'Disadvantaged Person' is one who is in financial hardship and disadvantaged due to:

- non-English speaking background, youth, or other cultural issues such as gender barriers preventing assistance;
- illiteracy in main language of country of origin;
- remote location;
- physical or psychological disability, including from past torture or trauma; or
- physical or psychological harm resulting from family violence.

Under the scheme NSS was able to provide advice and assistance to 155 eligible clients.

With the contract coming to an end in June 2011 DIAC announced a Request for Tender for Services under the IAAAS to continue and a response was submitted by the organisation in April 2011. However in June 2011 we were informed by DIAC that NSS was unsuccessful in its bid to deliver this valuable service beyond the 30 June 2011 contract date. A disappointing outcome for the region and those disadvantaged clients in the community who no longer had access to a local provider.

I am happy to announce however that in September 2011 NSS entered into an agreement with a preferred tenderer based in Sydney, Playfair Visa and Migration Services, to undertake work on their behalf on a fee for service basis throughout regional NSW.

In addition to the IAAAS the past year has seen the provision of quality, professional services on over 300 occasions to clients from culturally diverse backgrounds such as China, the Philippines, the Sudan, Thailand, Russia, India, Korea, and Liberia. Over 1000 telephone enquiries have been fielded and advice and assistance provided in a range of visa classes, both temporary and permanent.

Throughout the year the service has been complemented by quarterly outreach visits to the office by experienced Officers from the DIAC Parramatta Office. This service has been invaluable in providing clients in our region with the opportunity to meet and discuss face-to-face their specific needs with a Departmental Officer. Initiated in 1996 as a result of the closure of the local immigration office it continues today and we are most grateful for the support and assistance the Officers from Parramatta provide to our staff and clients. We look forward to maintaining a close working relationship with them in the future.

To the Board of Management and to our colleagues thank you for your continued dedication to our cause and for your support and guidance throughout the year.



Complex Case Support (CCS)

Kiri Hata

Funded by Department of Immigration & Citizenship

Background

The Department of Immigration and Citizenship funds a contract service for Complex Case Support and NSS is the local service provider.

The CCS assists new or recently arrived refugee clients experiencing extreme hardship and disadvantage in their settlement, above and beyond the more routine services which all refugees have access on arrival. Once the problem of the individual or family has been addressed the program enables those identified as CCS clients to return to continuing to re-establishing themselves.

Program Issues and Responses

Referrals to this program can come from within NSS as well as other agencies such as Schools, STARTTS, Centrelink, other Community agencies and Community Services. Support is determined after a client plan is developed and may be provided to individuals and families through a range of means and this can involve numerous agencies and individual project workers.

Various NSS programs may be utilised and where support for those matters fall under existing programs it is provided by staff currently working with the family. Other support may be called on as required.

Although all CCS contracts were due for completion on 30 June 2011, the Deed of Standing Offer was extended until 15 January 2012, under the existing term & conditions pending the outcome of the Request for Tender, for Complex Case Support Services in the Hunter Service Delivery Area.

Statistics for the period

Active cases	6
Referrals made	10
Rejections	3
Completed	5

Conclusion

This program allowed NSS to put the focus on specific clients and greatly improve their outcomes. To achieve good outcomes we were required to work closely with many other agencies with NSS taking the lead role and ensuring best practice and timely intervention.

\



Rural Support Settlement Grants Program

Alex Burns

Funded by Department of Immigration & Citizenship

- Settlement Grant Program (SGP)

This project continues to provide team leadership, assistance, mentoring and resourcing to NSS and other rural DIAC funded SGP projects who provide support to highly vulnerable new arrival refugees, family and other permanent visa holders in Northern and Western NSW. Much of this work reflects on the long history that I have had in the settlement of this project's target group and also with those mainstream services that work hard to give an equal service to our new arrivals as they do to whole community.

It has been a special year for me as I have not only witnessed Violetta's moving to a new phase of her life but it has been interesting for me to be involved in a number of events that summarised some of the history of NSS. This occurred in June when I represented NSS at the 2011 Refugee Council Conference held at the University of NSW and gave a paper on 30 years of refugee Settlement in rural and regional NSW. Later in the same month I had a similar experience to speak on the activities of NSS over time on the Central Coast of NSW to a meeting with the Mayor of Gosford and the areas Migrant and Refugee Communities. Much history and much experience.

Activities of the Project

Support was provided by the NSS Rural worker to DIAC projects in a range of diverse locations in Northern NSW- Lismore, Coffs Harbour, Manning Valley, Port Macquarie; Armidale, Tamworth Inverell and in Central Western NSW-Orange, Bathurst and Dubbo as well as the Central Coast and the Hunter Region including Newcastle.

In this area the client group comprises a large group of new arrivals that are from Humanitarian Entrant (Refugee) backgrounds.. This settlement with its particular needs has seen large numbers of refugees of diverse backgrounds, people from Burma, Ethiopia, Togo, Democratic Republic of Congo, South Sudan, Somalia and Liberia settle in Coffs Harbour and Woolgoolga. Others mainly from Africa have settled in Lismore, Armidale, Orange, Inverell and Bathurst. In Newcastle, the refugee population is similarly an African Refugee settlement area.

Although skilled migration into rural areas has increased, the largest number of migrants is arriving on Family visa, as spouses. Numbers of these find isolation a major issue and lack of social support to help maintain them and the SGP project workers provide group support as these new arrival integrate into local communities.

Achievements

Casework and Orientation Support

As this project backs up other projects to support their casework and also provides some direct casework Table 1 provides information on this and other project work as recorded in DIAC's Online Settlement Client Activity Recording (OSCAR) work.

Table 1: OSCARs for the Rural Support Grant 2010-2011

Clients	Case contacts	Short Contacts	Group Sessions
22	36	12376	47

A brief snapshot of the project's clientele and their issues shows that 76 percent of those supported were from refugee or humanitarian background. The largest number were from Southern Sudan and comprised Dinka speakers. Most lived in regional areas and in particular the New England region and this work probably is a reflection of more focussed work with the NSS offices in this region. Their issues were diverse but those relating to family relationships, migration, family violence, education child protection and community development made up the bulk of the work. 72 percent were helped after 1-2 contacts with the average time spent with most contacts being between 30-60 minutes.

Direct Work with Rural Based Projects

While the SGP project have great competencies with their casework sometimes strategies are required with specific clients to address major problems. This project counsels and mentors, advising project workers on how to best address these types of problems. Issues like the lack of services using interpreters in their dealings with our client target group and the problems this continues to have for our clients are the areas where this project's skills and advice on casework are mostly provided. Contact and support to the individual rural based SGP projects comprises visits and regular phone contact and more and more through the use of emails. The nature of the visits vary with each project with some of the work reflecting the individual need while in other instances relates to the team leader responsibilities with NSS SGP projects. As will be seen from Table 2 the largest number of visits was to the NSS managed projects, and this included the project's Rural Team Leader role for NSS. The year saw a much more stable group of SGP project workers although there was a change in Manning Valley while the Dubbo SGP project worker suffered a serious illness.

Table 2: Face to Face Visits to Regional and Rural SGP Projects

Location	Visits	Location	Visits
Manning Valley	5	Coffs Harbour	4
Lismore	3	Inverell	5
Armidale	5	Tamworth	6
Bathurst	4	Orange	4
Dubbo	3	Central Coast	10
Hunter Outreach	15	Refugee Communities	12
Homework Ctes	10	Youth	14

Individual project issues included new project worker selection, promotion of SGP role, setting in place appropriate accountability measures with this last issue being a major one that I tend to stress with every SGP project, competition with other services, DIAC settlement programs, SGP applications, events and other funding.

Other Work

This project continues to convene or support the strong multicultural regional interagencies and networks as well as a range of Commonwealth and State led forums centring on services to migrants and refugee. The project also provided a number of training opportunities to regional services to help these access the SGP target group, some in concert with other SGP projects....Another productive year.



Hunter Welfare Outreach Settlement Grants Program

Rose Oku

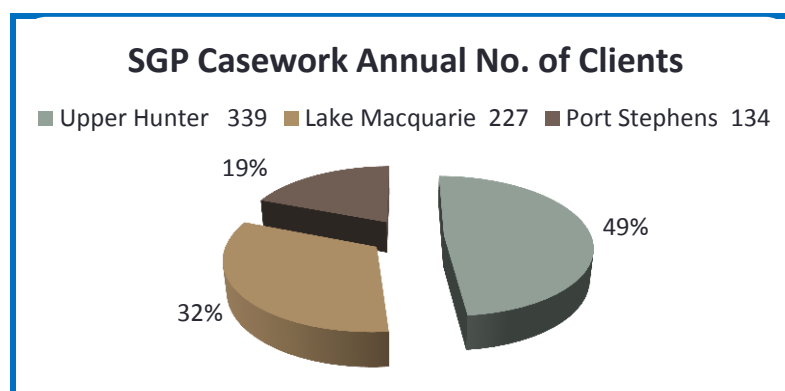
Funded by Department of Immigration & Citizenship
- Settlement Grant Program (SGP)

The Hunter Welfare Outreach SGP project provides support services to highly disadvantaged new arrival refugees and migrants, especially women who are experiencing hardship through isolation, domestic violence, homelessness and other misfortunes encountered in their settlement.

Casework

From 1st July 2010 to 30th June 2011, the Settlement Grants Project Outreach Worker has provided ongoing face to face casework for client groups in isolated parts of the Hunter, Port Stephens and Lake Macquarie areas, specifically for supporting families. The SGP continues to support complex casework so that client's needs are met by facilitating their access to a wide range of community resources and services like Centrelink, Childcare facilities, community health programs, and accommodation and tenancy services. The SGP has addressed over 700 Client Contacts during 2010-2011. 98% of these Clients received an average of between 35-45 minutes in consultation with the SGP worker. On average these clients were dealing with a wide range of intricate multiple issues. Some examples of these are; Domestic Violence, Accommodation, Family Relationships, Legal, Health, Document Help, Accommodation, Education and Training, Language problems, Employment and Financial Assistance.

Table 1: Casework: Upper Hunter, Port Stephens, and Lake Macquarie 2010-2011



Upper Hunter Region includes; Singleton, Cessnock, Kurri Kurri, Maitland, Abermain, and Rutherford

Lake Macquarie Region includes; Belmont, Toronto, Wangi, Charlestown, Warners Bay and Kotara

Port Stephens Region includes; Raymond Terrace, Shoal Bay, Nelsons Bay, Salt Ash and Medowie

Major Issues Identified with the Client group

Many individual concerns were raised during casework consultations, while other issues arose within group work and information sessions that needed to be addressed. These other issues related to:

- Accommodation
- Family Relationships
- Health
- Employment
- Material & Financial Assistance
- Education & Training
- Legal
- Document Help

Multicultural Friendship Groups are now based in several different locations throughout the Hunter and continue to expand with a new group in Lake Macquarie being formed. Other groups are located at Singleton, Cessnock, Port Stephens, and Maitland. These continue to meet regularly and hold information sessions.

During 2010-2011 there were 34 Information sessions held and addressed: women's health, isolation, education, community capacity building, family relationships, and employment issues. These sessions were held in partnership with other services like Community Health, Centrelink, Hunter New England Health, Hunter Volunteers, the Cessnock Art Gallery, Relay for Life, Photography Workshops, the Tenancy Advice Service, and NSW TAFE.



Other sessions included Make Up, Cooking, Flower, Arts and Craft Demonstrations. The SGP continues to develop a pool of volunteers from the client group with the support of the Rural Support project and local Councils.

In September, a number of the Singleton Women's group had volunteered in the schools where their children attended. They provided positive feedback -it had been a good experience which had benefited children as their parents were involved in school and classroom activities. Other children in the school were given the opportunity to learn about other cultures and where their classmates came from. By volunteering within the school these parents were achieving significant milestones by raising cultural awareness to appreciate the concept of migrant presence in their community.

Promotional Activities and Networking

During the 2010-2011 the SGP has participated in and attended various promotional and networking activities and functions. The success of the project has been due to the SGP's capacity to network with other organisations. The SGP has represented the NSS on a number of occasions by participating as guest speaker for the Charlestown Rotary Club and Citizenship Ceremony's held at Lake Macquarie City Council; presenting a symposium Celebrating Inspiration and Creating Partnership with the partners of the Hunter Valley Multicultural Friendship Group held at Cessnock.

The SGP worker has attended various planning meetings that have allowed her to develop knowledge on specific services through these networking relationships so that clients were able to achieve good outcomes. Networking also included convening 4 meetings of the Hunter Rural Multicultural Network where workers were able to share information on the target group, refer sensitive case work to familiar services and to develop a strong base on issues that impacted on the new arrival clients.

Other networking was conducted through formal planning meetings, with local councils, government agencies and departments like Lake Macquarie City Council, Centrelink and other inter-agencies. Lake Macquarie Council approached NSS about Australia Day Celebration 2011. The SGP Worker also participated in International Women's Day Celebrations at Hunter Women's Centre.

Community Events like Australia Day Celebrations, Harmony Day and Refugee Week

The target group was encouraged to participate in community events especially events like Australia Day Celebrations, Harmony Day and Refugee Week. In 2010 the Port Stephens Group had successfully applied and received funding for Living in Harmony Celebrations 2012. Members of the target group attended the Australia Day Celebrations at Lake Macquarie Council to give dancing demonstrations and sell food throughout the day. The Singleton Women's Group participated in Harmony Day in partnership with Singleton Council and 50-70 people attended. Harmony Day Celebrations were also held with Tomaree Neighbourhood Centre and 40 -50 people attended. A guest speaker from NSS gave an overview of the organisation. The Cessnock group participated in Harmony Day Celebrations 23rd March at Cessnock. Harmony Day activities throughout the Hunter included African Drumming, dancing, sharing multicultural foods, choirs, and ornaments and arts.

Finally it has been a hectic year with the project's refugee and migrant client groups achieving some milestones, as they work towards living and working autonomously in Australia with positive outcomes.





New England Settlement Grants Program (Armidale)

Judith Roberts

Funded by Department of Immigration & Citizenship
- Settlement Grants Program (SGP)

The Armidale SGP provides settlement information, referrals, community capacity building, service planning and development to new arrivals migrants and humanitarian entrants, and the dependents of skilled migrants.

The clients most represented to this service are humanitarian entrants who are single parents with large families, single men and an emerging group are the wives of young refugee men who returned to their home countries to marry but the new arrivals are for the most part under Family Stream visas.

Issues for this group relate to access to education, AMEP, housing, employment and child care. Some clients have required intensive settlement support but had good outcomes. Many clients continue experience distress around family members in Africa who they would like to propose and who have sought support from the NSS Migration Agents and DIAC when outreach visits are made to the area to file applications.

Table 1 Client Statistics

Type	Number
OSCAR 1	19
OSCAR 2	1,364
OSCAR 3	6,881
OSCAR 4	132

Client Services

Overall client issues identified included: accommodation, family relationships/ breakdowns, access to mental health support, Centrelink, employment, transport, debt issues, access to driving lessons, and health access homework support, access and equity, access to childcare and to suitable English classes. Many of the women clients face the added challenges as sole parents due to their husband's return to the country of origin, death, or family breakdown.

Many of the young men are also quite a disadvantaged group whose main issues include employment, access to driving lessons, housing, and access to education and training. Nonetheless, employment opportunities for many new settlers has been improved with many having found work in industries such as the Guyra Tomato Farm, Aged Care, security work and contract cleaning. NSS works with Job Networks to support clients and has a MOU with Advanced Personnel Management and has worked closely with other agencies such as the Commonwealth Rehabilitation Service and Centrelink to support clients. NSS supports the attendance of our target group at AMEP and LLNP classes at TAFE.

Many of our target group have been supported into stable accommodation through private rentals or through public and community housing. There have been many, many excellent outcomes for our target group and a number of students who are at the University of New England and the TAFE across a range of disciplines.

The new build public housing in Armidale has seen single men and families into stable accommodation. New babies have been born into recently arrived families this year and have created a lot of joy for their families and the community.

Refugee and ESL Homework Support

The Refugee Homework Support is again primarily funded by the Department of Education and Communities and has also been strongly supported by Armidale Sanctuary. NSS continues its involvement with this program mainly through the management and enrolment of volunteer tutors and assistance for special events.

English Conversation Classes for Sudanese Women

NSS in collaboration with DEC and Armidale Sanctuary commenced an English program for Sudanese women in early 2011 as an extension of the AMEP and LLNP classes at the Armidale TAFE. These classes were well attended and had a core group of women in attendance of 5 or 6.

Information Sessions

The English Conversation classes were an opportunity to raise a number of settlement issues with clients including childcare and other day to day settlement issues such as appointment etiquette and vocational information.

Meetings, Networking and Committee representation

The SGP is involved in a broad range of networks through attendance at various meetings. Some of these include the Multicultural Interagency Meeting, NE Multicultural Health Access Committee, DEC Equity, Refugee Student Support, ESL Home Work Support, Armidale Interagency and Sanctuary Armidale. NSS Armidale also works closely with the region's Refugee Health Nurse and in all ways ensures that the health needs of our target group are supported in the best possible way. NSS Armidale has been able to support the work of the STARTTS from Coffs Harbour. The commitment made to the mental wellbeing of the Refugee community by STARTTS with the cooperation of the SGP is making a real difference to the quality of settler's lives and is providing a caring settlement to new and longer term arrivals.

Refugee Week Events

The highlight of Refugee Week Celebrations this year once again was the Armidale Dumaresq Mayor's Morning Tea which was held on the 21st of June. Refugees and their supporters were invited to the Council Chambers by the ADC Mayor Mr Peter Ducat. Mayor Ducat commended the refugees present for their continuing commitment to the Armidale community and thanked all those who welcome and support the refugees into the New England. Once again, Sanctuary Armidale was a strong presence as well. Representatives of Hunter New England Health, Department of Education and Communities and many more were also present. The Refugee Council also sent a representative to Armidale along with Tamworth and Inverell who spoke on the 'Go Back Where They Came From' documentary that had been recently shown on SBS. The SGP has been able to promote and liaise with all concerned to make these Refugee Week events and projects the wonderful success they have been.

Summary

Despite these challenges the SGP often in collaboration with Sanctuary Armidale, continues to network closely with the community and has supported great outcomes and achievements for new settlers.



New England Settlement Grants Program (Tamworth)

Amalin Sundaravej

Funded by Department of Immigration & Citizenship

- Settlement Grants Program (SGP)

The Tamworth base of the New England Settlement Grants Program (SGP) provides support services to highly disadvantaged new arrival refugees, family and other permanent resident visa holders who have low English language proficiency. Clients experience hardship through isolation, domestic violence, homelessness, mental health and other issues.

The Tamworth work has also addressed the lack of supportive networks, assisting the refugee and migrant community's development and promoting a sense of self identity, belonging and participation with the broader Tamworth community. It also raises awareness among the mainstream service providers to assist them to become more responsive to needs of the target group in the Tamworth area.

Overview of 2010-2011

Table 1 lists the project work during 2010-2011:

Table 1: Client Contact & Project Work: 2009-2010

New Clients	Client Contacts	Telephone Calls and Emails	Group Work
31	190	2916	47

Client services covered a range of issues including: citizenship, housing, employment, health, education, training, religion, English language proficiency, family relationship, parenting issues, domestic violence, legal issues, legal aid assistance, overseas skills recognition, driving among others.

Referrals were made to: Sigma Aerospace, DEEWR Rural Tertiary Hardship Fund, NSS Migration Agents, Regional Development Australia, Women's Legal Service, Peel Health Care, Skilled Employment, Baiada, Family Support Services (Tamworth) Tamworth Women and Children's Refuge and Trade Recognition Australia.

Employment, housing, English language proficiency and obtaining driver's license were priority areas for new migrants during the year. Most were successful especially in getting their P plate licenses. This has given them more freedom and mobility including better job opportunities.

Clients assisted and supported originate from Sudan, Philippines, Thailand, Vietnam, India, Bosnia, Ukraine, Slovenia, Czechoslovakia, Malta, Japan, South Korea, Turkey, China, Sri Lanka and Eritrea.

The largest numbers of the client group are from the Philippines who have settled as spouses. However the second largest group are people from Sudan, who are refugees who have sought work in the industries found in Tamworth or have wanted a better (safer) environment for their children. A problem for the Africans has been in obtaining rental accommodation and their access to housing has been limited. This has been a difficulty and they have not been able to bring their family to live with them.

Table 2: New Clients by Country of Origin

Background of Clients	Number
Sudan	5
Philippines	5
Thailand	2
Vietnam	1
India	5
Turkey	1
Eritrea	1
Malta	2
Bosnia	2
Slovenia	1
Ukraine	1
Czech Republic	1
China	4
TOTAL	31

Employment opportunities

In Tamworth, employment opportunities for our target group is more towards the low skills area like the abattoirs (Country Fresh and Teys Australia) and chicken processing plants (i.e., Baiada and Red Lea). These are the major sources of employment that continue to attract the African (male) community as well as the new male and some female migrants. Other migrant communities and especially Filipino women are employed more widely in chicken hatchery plants, egg picking and packing. A few women have now obtained aged care certificates and are now employed on a casual or part-time basis.

Those with overseas professional skills continues to have difficulty in finding acceptance in the workplace as they do not have the local experience and tend to resort to the low skill employment such as labouring. This is due to the language barriers, lack of, or no recognition of their skills in Australia which is an expensive and lengthy process. Fluency in the English language is limited and it is a big hindrance and also a barrier in their search for employment.

Networking

During the reporting period, the SGP contacts and networks have vastly improved and these served to improve NSS links as a better and more responsive service provider. NSS Tamworth has been actively involved in promoting issues and awareness on multicultural issues as evident in this year's highlights including participation in Harmony Day 2011 celebrations and the Refuge Week event This was opened by the Mayor of Tamworth and attended by both the Federal and State MPs and documented through good coverage in all media, newspapers, television and radio. A very successful Multicultural Services Expo 2011 was also held in Tamworth.

Cooperation and collaboration with the Tamworth Regional Council has been paramount and included working closely with the newly created Community and Development Officer (Cultural Diversity), the Tamworth Youth Coordinator, the Tamworth City Public Library and the Tamworth Gallery.





New England Settlement Grants Program (Inverell)

Katie Wright

Funded by Department of Immigration & Citizenship
- Settlement Grants Program (SGP)

The Inverell project provides a support service to refugees and family stream migrants within the local area most whom are disadvantaged often have low English language proficiency and may be experiencing hardship through isolation, domestic violence, homelessness, mental health and other misfortunes encountered in their settlement.

The Inverell office operated 14 hours a week during the year and provided settlement information and orientation, capacity building and social integration. Referrals to main stream service providers have been vital and a strong relationship ensured that services were accessible and equitable to the client group.

Client Services

The client group at this point in the project originate from the African Countries of Sudan, Kenya and the democratic Republic of Congo. Issues addressed included the following: employment, special educational needs, lack of use of interpreter and translator services, as well as a lack of health services, social participation, existence of isolation from main family group, problems with relationships, transportation, financial management, legal, counselling, childcare, tenancy issues, managing neighbour conflict, accommodation, education & training and general document assistance.

Significant support and assistance was provided to a family that through lack of employment sought opportunities for their families in other parts of Australia. The Inverell SGP project facilitated the logistics and assisted with some of these moves.

Network and Community Relations

Participation and attendance of community meetings has been essential. Meetings regularly attended have included Inverell Sanctuary, Inverell Interagency, Inverell Anti-Violence Committee, Love Bites Committee and the New England Multicultural Interagency.

Community awareness of the project within the local area and promotion of NSS was delivered to large number of agencies service providers and organisations. Flyers and brochures are prominently displayed in many relevant contact points for our target client group.

A sound relationship has been built with education providers e.g. TAFE and local schools, Police Department, Health Professionals, Local Counselling services, Inverell Refuge, Job Agencies, Centrelink, STARTTS and other counselling services, DOCS, Sanctuary, Inverell Shire Council, Members of Parliament, Religious Groups, Community Groups and many other people and providers that play an important role in the settlement of our clients.

Community Events

During the year the Inverell project was involved with numbers of local events as well as these that reflected the region. These were:

Multicultural Services Expo – 4th November

The Expo attracted 66 people in total and was a successful day. 11 organisations serving the CALD community were represented through short but informative presentations. Attendees from across the Inverell Community included Inverell Shire Council, Community Services, Brighter Futures, Benevolent Society, Local Government, TAFE and various Religious Organisations.

White Ribbon Day Luncheon and End the Silence on Domestic Violence March – 25th November 2010

White Ribbon Day promoted anti-family violence and included a small number of the project's clients. Approximately 55 people afterwards marched through Inverell's main street as an anti-violence statement.

Harmony Day 2011-21st March 2011

In conjunction with the local TAFE coordinated a Harmony Day afternoon tea for 60 people. In attendance were several clients, Refugee Health, Multicultural Child Care Worker, the Benevolent Society, Local Council members, Inverell Family Youth Support, Linking Together Centre and local media.

Refugee Week- Refugees, Asylum Seekers and the TRUTH -29th June 2011

Hosted Open Community Forum with a guest speaker from the Refugee Council of Australia. 50 people attended from various backgrounds and age groups. The event was well received with promotion in the local newspaper and a community radio interview

Summer Sun Youth Festival (SSYF) – 5th February 2011

In conjunction with local council and other service providers this was a youth day that targeted 12 -18 year olds. NSS clients were encouraged to be involved and an African hair braiding tent was part of the day.

Conclusion

I am so proud to have been a part of NSS and I believe the work we do is vital not only for the clients we support but for the communities they must live within.

As I leave NSS to continue my studies I would like to take this opportunity to say a sincere thank you to my co-workers in NSS and especially Judy Roberts who I would be lost without. I wish all at NSS well and I also want to thank Violetta for her encouragement.



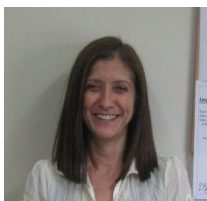
Northern Settlement Services -Central Coast Introduction

The Central Coast Team

The NSS Central Coast office is located in the Tuggerah Lakes Community Centre building, in Bateau Bay.

The Central Coast team comprises 8 staff manning 3 projects: the Multicultural Social Support Service, the Settlement Grants project and the Multicultural Family Worker project.

The team underwent a number of changes over the 2010-2011 year with some staff moving to greener pastures and new staff coming on board. It also saw one of our stalwarts, Pari, involved in a major accident, and at time of writing this report, still sees her incapacitated. Thus this year we said goodbye to Trudy Wahl, Julie Styles and Danielle Habib and welcomed, Kellie Matterson, Marilyn Pérez Cabrera and Natalia Meliendrez.



While we are a team, all project workers owe a great deal to our administration and financial staff and for their support and I wish to thank Sharlene Huber (far left), Julie Styles and Marilyn Pérez Cabrera (left) who contribute and cover equally our Central Coast projects.



Multicultural Social Support Service

Olivia Fuente, Anita Trainor & Kellie Matterson

Funded by Department of Ageing, Disability & Home Care
– Home & Community Care (HACC) Program

The Multicultural Social Support Service (MSSS) supports CALD people in Wyong & Gosford LGAs who are: frail aged, younger people with a disability, and carers.

To introduce Kellie Matterson, the new MSSS Coordinator who joined NSS in February 2011. Having come from an Aged Care background and previously worked in a Multicultural Community Centre I have combined these skills to work with MSSS.

Model of Service Provision

While the model of service provision is based on the Coordinators working to train and match volunteers to provide social support to clients and carers, it also comprises group respite which takes place at a number of locations. Kellie provided 4 days a week to the MSSS project, Olivia 2 days and Anita 2-3 days to the group work and 1-2 days to the Coordination role. The support provided includes: home visits, telephone calls, taking clients to: shopping, banking, to medical appointments etc. and supporting clients to attend outings and events, including organised client activity days by the MSSS.

ADMINISTRATION

The following administration tasks have been undertaken throughout the year.

- Bi-Monthly media releases inform the community about MSSS, and are also for the purpose of recruiting new Volunteers and clients. 70 Volunteer application kits were sent out, and as a result 36% of Volunteer applicants found out about the service through service promotion, Harmony Day, Expos, followed closely by 21% through Newspapers and Radio, 10% through TAFE Presentation, 7% Volunteering Australia, and 26% through Staff, walk-in, internet search, friends and referrals from different sources.

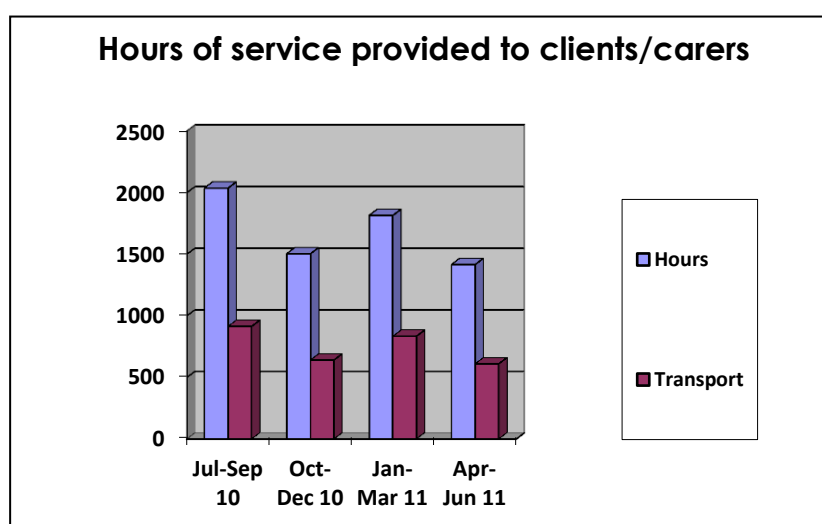
VOLUNTEERS

- To date, the service has 35 registered Volunteers, 31 of whom are actively involved with clients, and of which, 23 speak languages other than English.
- Four Training days and Supervision & Support Meetings have been held throughout the year. Training has included: Vital First Aid, Introduction to Dementia; AON Insurance Update; Legal Issues – a combined Client and Volunteer Day, and the importance of NSS/MSSS Volunteer's Policy and Procedure.
- The number of volunteers has a slight decrease throughout 2010-2011 mainly due to some volunteer's personal/family issues.
- Volunteers have continued to assist with transport and activities on our regular monthly client days, including weekly groups in Wyong, the Peninsula and Gosford as well as providing one on one support.

- Volunteers were given special lunches during National Volunteer Week in May, where we recognise their contribution to the service and also in November, end of the year get-together.

CLIENTS/CARERS

- MSSS provide services to 85 (out of 97) clients and carers. The services are mainly shopping, medical appointments and social activities. We continue to receive referrals for clients from ACAT, Community Nursing, local hospitals, other community services, word of mouth, self-referrals and from our advertising and promotions.
- Our monthly client group days continue to be popular. This year, the activities have included Indoor Games Day, Bastille Day, Tai Chi Demonstration, Lunch at The Greens (The Entrance), Picnic at Long Jetty Waterfront, Client's get-together and a catered Christmas Lunch with entertainer.
- Nationalities represented within our Client/Carer service include Chinese, Polish, Maltese, Singaporean, Filipino, Spanish, Greek, Italian, Austrian, German, Croatian, Finnish, Hungarian, Serbian, Dutch, Fijian, Egyptian, Vietnamese, Uruguayan, Macedonian, Indian, French, Persian, Latvian, Argentinian, Peruvian, Portuguese, Malaysian.



MSSS PROMOTION 2010 - 2011

CC Multicultural Expo	Gosford Harmony Day	Wyong Interagency
CC Mental Health Forum	Volunteer Expo at Erina	Refugee Week Activity
Manager of Volunteers Forums	Community Partnership Forum	Life Matters Seminar
Stay Safe at the Beach	Connect Day at Niagara Park	Mental Health week
Meeting Minister Mark Butler	NSW / CC Volunteering Strategy Workshop	CALD Forum
Central Coast TAFE colleges	Multicultural Expo	Multicultural Interagency
CCADA	Southern Lakes Baby Expo	

We have continued to advertise: in the local media; The Senior newspaper; Community Newsletters; at Neighbourhood Centres, etc, by continuous distribution of service brochures, and by networking with other community services.



Multicultural Social Support Service (Groups)

Anita Trainor

Funded by Department of Ageing, Disability & Home Care
– Home & Community Care (HACC) Program

Purpose

The purpose of this project is to provide group opportunities for people born overseas (CALD) who live on the Central Coast and are isolated so that they can meet, interact socially, share food together, play games, listen to music, discuss topics which interest them and talk about their past experiences in their countries of origin and/or Australia.

The three group locations were initially: Woy Woy, Blue Haven and Mangrove Mountain. The groups were to be held on a weekly basis.

Woy Woy Group

This group functions from the Peninsula Community Centre on Thursdays. It has been very successful from the beginning, attracting people not only from the Peninsula but also from nearby areas, such as green Point and Terrigal. Some of its members have been attending regularly from the beginning of May 2010 when the group commenced its activities. An average of 6-9 people attends but at times, the attendance has increased to 12. This group is really functional and the people attending it have become good supporting friends.

Blue Haven (Now Lake Haven) Group

This group, which meets on Tuesdays, had difficulties in recruiting members. One of the main reasons for people not to attend was the location. Clients stated that the location was too isolated and public transport to and from Blue Haven was non-existent. People wanted to change the location to Lake Haven because of the shopping centre facilities and the availability of public transport. They wanted to make "more of a day out" of this day, taking the opportunity to buy some groceries and go to the bank.

A new location was found at Gravity Youth Centre, which is located in the same complex of Lake Haven Shopping Centre. However the group only commenced meeting at the new venue during the first week of July 2011.

Mangrove Mountain Group

Despite the intense work of the MSSS team in attracting referrals for this group, only one referral was received. The person referred was being collected to attend the Woy Woy group because of her need for social contact, however the service user was referred on as she needed more intense services.

Volunteers

The groups could not have succeeded without the help of a group of volunteers, who transport the service users to and from the group venue. Volunteers also assist with the preparation of morning tea and general care of the service users. There are two committed volunteers who have been assisting with the Woy Woy group from the beginning in May 2010.

Issues arising during group meetings

The group meetings have been an ideal venue to find out other unmet needs that service users have. In this respect, referrals to other services have been made in consultation with the service users. The services where referrals have been sent to were: ACAT for assessments, Central Coast Casework Management, ADSSI, Meals on Wheels, etc.

Numbers of service users attending the groups

Woy Woy	315
Blue Haven	74
Total	389

Nationalities of the group members

The service users attending the groups were born in the following countries: Germany, Spain, Hungary, France, Fiji, Italy, Egypt, Peru, Chile, Finland, Nicaragua, Argentina, Uruguay, China, Greece, South Africa, Lebanon, the Philippines.

Other duties

Initially I was employed for 3 days per week. At the beginning of October 2010, I commenced to work an extra day which was to be used to coordinate the services in the Gosford LGA. At the beginning of April 2011, I commenced to work 2 extra days to share the coordination role of the Wyong LGA.

I have also joined the two other coordinators in holding the monthly service users social function at Bateau Bay.

I have participated in training days for volunteers. I have also attended some training days which were interesting and beneficial for the work that I perform.

I have assisted other workers from the NSS team in promotional activities so that the profile of NSS is raised within the community. In this regard, I have also promoted the organization by visiting TAFE centres where I was able to speak to the CALD students about NSS and distribute brochures of the organisation.

I also conducted a similar education session for nurses at Wyong Hospital. This information session was very productive as most of the nurses attending were not aware of the services that this organisation provides.

I am extremely happy with the achievements of MSSS during the financial year 2010-2011 and expect that the organisation will continue to grow in the number of service users and volunteers.



Settlement Grants Program – Central Coast

Danielle Habib

Funded by Department of Immigration & Citizenship

This project provides information, referral and support to highly disadvantaged, newly arrived migrants and refugees within their first five years of settlement to new arrival Humanitarian Entrants and eligible Migrants on the Central Coast of NSW.

Table 1: Client Issues- 2010-2011

Case Work Issues		Contacts (percent of work)	
Accommodation	16	Education/ Training	3
Family Violence	11	Mental Health	3
Financial	9	Immigration	2
Migration Advice –Migration Agent	7	Police and Court	2
Employment	5	Language	2
Document Help	5	Driving/License	2
Legal	5	Material Assistance	1
Family & Relationships/	4	Other	23

TOTAL CLIENT ISSUES: 100

Casework Issues

Table 1 shows the major casework issues, with accommodation needs showing an increase over previous years. Family violence like last year also has grown, but it also interacts with the need for clients to access alternate accommodation and to be supported by NSS Migration Agents and with Centrelink where income is also an issue. The clients come from a variety of backgrounds but were mainly from China, Egypt, Germany, the Philippines, Fiji Somali Chile and Korea.

Community Capacity Building

The Central Coast is continuing to see growth in the migrant population with 3465 new arrivals in the last 5 years. Most of these came under the Skilled or Family migration program areas with large numbers from the UK, the USA, Germany, India, China, Korea, the Philippines, South Africa and Thailand. The project has proven to be a leader in successful community capacity building through a number of projects which have included:

- **“Stay Safe at the Beach” December 10-12, 2010**

The project worked in partnership with Centrelink, Gosford and Wyong Councils and attracted nearly 700 people over 2 days. The event fostered a safe and healthy community; to develop skills and knowledge in the area of surf safety and awareness. The event was also nominated and won the NSW Water Safety Award.

- **“Interpreting Day”**

The SGP worker was supported by the Central Coast Multicultural Interagency (CCMI), Community Relations Commission, Police, Health, Department of Education, Centrelink and CC Disability Network to conduct an Interpreter week. The target group was new arrivals and longer settled migrant communities and mainstream services. While a weeklong event was planned the 9th November was chosen to be the focus of a workshop.

Interpreting Day-continued ... The session attracted 20 participants, ran for 3 hours and covered how to access interpreter services and how to use interpreter services. The CRC, Health and Centrelink provided experienced Interpreters to address those present while show bags of useful information on interpreters was supplied by the CRC.

• **The Culturally and Linguistically Diverse Domestic Violence Steering Committee**

The SGP worker supported the CALD DV Steering Committee to conduct several domestic violence awareness information session throughout the year. The first of these was held on the 28th October with 30 CALD community members attending. A second session was held on the 1st February with 29 services attending and a final session took place on the 4th April 34 services attending. This work and the outcomes has strengthened community partnerships with the Women's Health Centre, Health, Centrelink and also the Domestic Violence Court Support Advocacy Service.

The SGP worker also worked with the NSS multicultural Family Worker and the CALD DV Steering Committee to develop the "Love Bites" program for a poster project to be conducted at Gorokan High School. This took place on 7th Dec 2010. This project saw year 10 students design a poster with the logo "Domestic Violence is not ok in any culture".

• **Connect Day**

The SGP worker worked with the Department of Premiers and Cabinet to assist with the holding of a welfare organisations' "Connect Day". This day took place on the 26th October, 2010 with 16 organisations participating and included assisting disadvantaged communities, with a focus on assisting the CALD community to access services and also obtain information on support services that is available on the Central Coast. 800 people attended.

• **Harmony Day**

Opportunity lost. A good deal of work went into the development of a major Harmony Day event for March 2011. Work was undertaken with the Greek Hellenic Community of the Central Coast, Central Coast African Community, CC Chinese Community, Hungarian Connections and the Italian Friendship Group to successfully and these communities received \$15,000 in funding for the day. Lengthy preparations were made for a major event for the Central Coast but unfortunately the day was rained out.

Networking and Integration Services

The project is continuing to convene the Central Coast Multicultural Interagency. Many services participated in the bimonthly meeting throughout the year at meetings that included sharing information, arranging specific speakers to talk on services advocating for the CALD community and promoting the Multicultural Expo.

Issues raised at the CCMI included: lack of use of interpreters, G.P.s lack of use of Interpreters, Domestic violence and increasing difficulty in clients obtaining affordable housing.

The Multicultural Expo was a great success and took place on the 22nd September 2010, with 41 services participating. Some 450 people attended with most of these being clients of CALD background.



Multicultural Family Support Project

Pari Batha/ Natalia Meliendrez

Funded by Human Services, Community Services

At the end of March, Pari was involved in a major accident and is currently recovering. In April, Natalia Meliendrez joined NSS as locum to Pari and has filled this role with great skill and ability.

Natalia says of herself and her work, "Hi my name is Natalia Meliendrez, I am from Buenos Aires, Argentina. My favourite colours are blue and pink, I love dancing, cooking and also playing soccer. The best place I have visited is The Glacier, (South of Argentina), two places I would love to go are Paris and Egypt. I have a few future plans and goals that I would like to reach. At the moment, I am replacing Pari Batha until she recovers and fit to return. The role, is giving me the chance to work in one of the most challenging positions I have ever had. I keep thinking a way to describe how thankful I am in my new country, which I called home, for giving me the chance to do this job. For me, every day, as I drive to the office, to meetings, to see a client or to set up for an event- is a new experience and a day to remember and to learn from".

This project provides support to people from (CALD) backgrounds that live on the Central Coast. In particular, it has assisted women, families with young children and adolescents. The project also supports the general community, government and non-government organisations and, ethnic groups and communities by providing information; referral and case work. In addition the project provides advocacy for clients in order for them to access relevant services. The project is available at NSS Central Coast office (Bateau Bay) three days per week and on other days at Outreach locations (Green Point, Wyong and Gosford)

Table 1: Issues/Problems Presented by Clients: 2010-2011

Problem/Issues	Face to Face	Telephone
Immigration	5	11
Income support	28	57
Education	51	92
Mental Health & Health	29	86
Housing	32	70
Legal	44	39
Employment	3	4
Domestic Violence	30	80
Referring clients to Ethnic Groups	43	104
Total	265	543

Table 1 shows the main issues with which clients needed assistance during these 12 months. On the whole the issues continue as in previous years but there was a slight rise in the number of clients in DV situations.

Community Development:

The project has been involved in several areas of community development and these covered a variety of approaches-including promoting the CALD community through a monthly Community multicultural cooking program, through a monthly Multicultural film program – Film Global- and through annual national events like Refugee Week. Other community Capacity building included partnering other agencies and as the project is part of the Central Coast Multicultural Interagency (CCMI) with the Multicultural Expo, the Stay Safe at the Beach and the Central Coast Interpreters Day.

Presentation of Cultural awareness to mainstream services was another component of the project. Presentations were given to TAFE students, to the Central Coast Volunteer agency and to other mainstream services around working with the Ethnic community.

Perhaps the most important work was with the CALD communities themselves. Work with the communities included participating in special events, regularly consulting with the groups and their leaders and ongoing promotion of the communities, an issue that pervaded much of the discussion that took place. Contact was made in some instances to support the provision of the "Film Global" night, and to arrange participation in communal events and partnerships such as the monthly cooking demonstration held in partnership with Green Point Community Centre, the annual Harmony Day and Refugee Week and some of the special projects such as the Interpreter Training Day, the Multicultural Expo and the Stay Safe at The Beach days.

Leaders of the ethnic and religious contacted included: the Central Coast Chinese Association, Chinese Business Association, Dutch Group, Alliance Française, Central Coast Finnish of Gosford, Central Coast Australian Italian Friendship Society, Ekta Mandir Indian Group, Tairoto Marae Association- Maori group, Australian Filipino Association, the Iranian community, Fijian Women's Association, Latino's and Friends on the Coast, Also Gosford Baha'i Community Wonkwang Zen Cultural House- Buddhism Centre. In all the numbers consulted would have been 94 community members.

Some of the main issues raised by the CALD groups and their leaders were domestic violence, access to premises for groups, accessing the media and promoting the individual groups, formation of a Central Coast ethnic community body, housing and rental problems, accessing grants and other sources of funding for community events and general feelings of isolation.

Multicultural Movie Night (Film Global Night)

The Multicultural Movie Night is a regular event occurring every third Friday of each month and hosted by the Erina Youth Centre. This is a partnership between the project and Gosford Council Youth Services. The evening starts with a cultural performance, culturally specific foods that are introduced to the audience and a film from the host country. The cultural groups participating include: France, Iran, Uruguay, India, Greece, New Zealand/Maori, Italy, Philippines, China and many others. 50 to 150 people attend the movie night each month.

Meetings and Networks

The project participates in several meetings, some to arrange special events like the Stay Safe at the Beach while others relate to sharing information. The meetings include: Central Coast Multicultural Interagency, the Community Services Hunter and Central Coast Advisory Committee, the Multicultural Mental Health Advisory Committee, the CALD DV Steering Committee, and Northern Settlement Services Case Workers meeting.



Community Aged Care Packages

Sue Hristov, Lupe Fonua & Tima 'Oto

Funded by Commonwealth Department of Health & Ageing

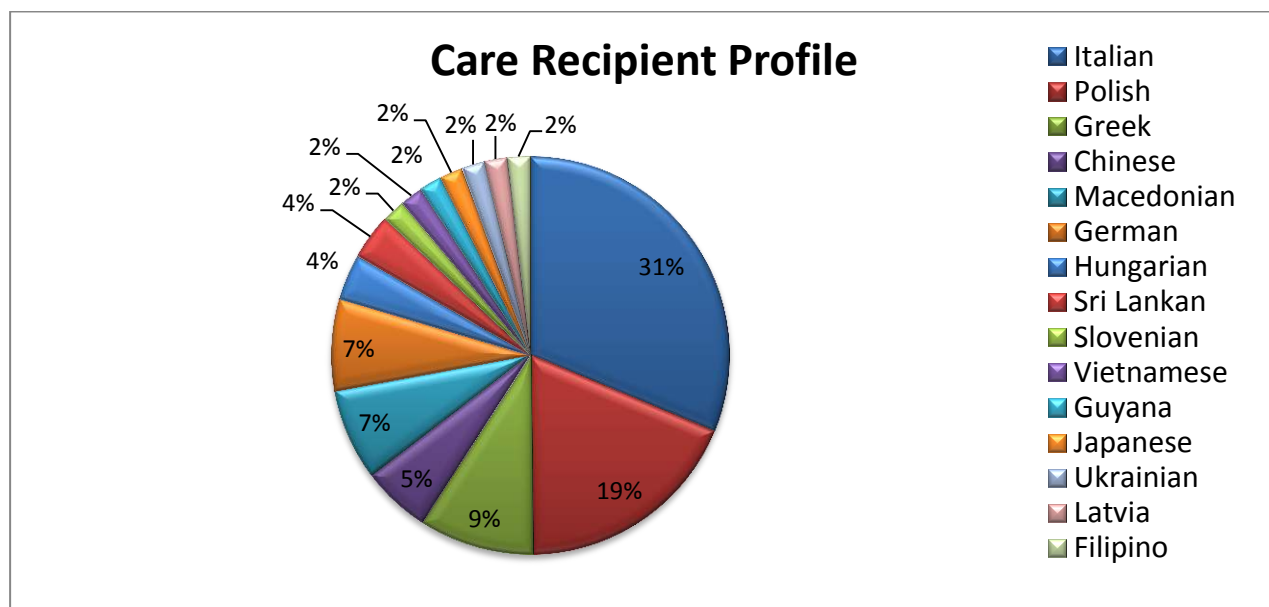
The Community Aged Care Packages (CACP) program is in its 11th year of successful operation and continues to provide home based care and assistance to vulnerable, frail aged people who have complex care needs.

Our target group is older people from Culturally and Linguistically Diverse Backgrounds (CALD) in the Hunter region, who need assistance with the tasks of daily living to improve their quality of life and enable them to stay living at home as long as possible. We are currently funded to provide assistance to 42 people- however, as in the past, prudent financial management enables us to help an additional 3 people (unfunded).

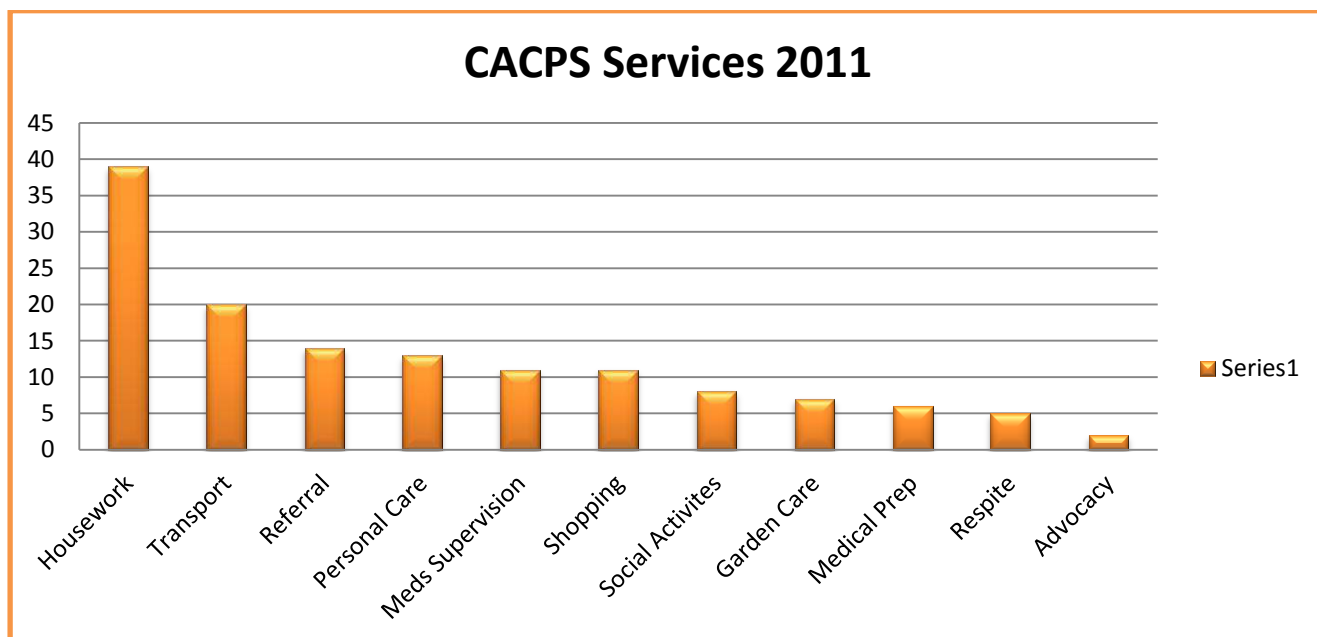
It also enables us to respond to occasional requests from the Aged Care Assessment Team (with the approval of CEO/Accounts Department) to provide assistance to people they have assessed as being an urgent priority, even though we do not have a current funded vacancy

CARE RECIPIENT PROFILE

Care recipients come from 15 different cultural backgrounds



Total of 45 care recipients: 34 Female -12 Male- age range from 74 to 96 years old
29 living at home alone - 16 have a carer living with them and 12 have a diagnosis of dementia.



LEVEL OF SERVICE PROVISION - we currently provide 165 hrs/week of direct assistance - an average of 3.6 hrs /care recipient – some need only 1-2 hrs/ week and others with complex care needs required significantly more- one as high as 14.5hrs/ week. The past year has seen a significant increase in the number of people - 28% (18% last year) who required a higher level of care than a CACP is generally designed to provide- about 5.5hrs/wk – although a lot of those higher care clients have exited the packages since June.

MODEL OF SERVICE PROVISION - we continue to use the Brokerage Model for direct service provision- as it has proven to be the most effective and efficient way of meeting the linguistic and cultural needs of our client group. The overall responsibility for Program management/ Service Coordination rests with the 3 Coordinators who are on call 24 hours a day seven days a week, while direct service provision (care workers who go to people's homes) is contracted from 5 reputable agencies. Case management/ ongoing monitoring of complex care needs continues to be the most challenging and also the most rewarding part of the job.

A major change for the Aged Care sector this year has been the move for all aged care funding/policy management to the Commonwealth and the introduction of Common Standards for Community care which now applies to CACP as well as all the previously State funded aged care programs. Another significant milestone has been the release of the Productivity Commission Report into Aged Care Reform- which has made innovative recommendations which if adopted by the Government (they are likely to respond by December) could mean significant challenges/ changes for the sector in the near future.

A busy and rewarding year for the CACP Project – the continuing support from the Board of Management, Violetta/ Lulu / Mary, the admin team/ fellow team members/colleagues and service providers is appreciated & makes NSS a good place to work.



Hunter Multicultural Respite Service

Tima 'Oto

Funded by Department of Ageing, Disability & Homecare
- Home & Community Care Program (HACC)

Hunter Multicultural Respite Service (HMRS) provides respite care for frail older people or people with dementia from non-English speaking backgrounds experiencing difficulty in attending Day Care Centres. The service provides a culturally appropriate worker to assist with care of clients at Day Care Centres to sustain their placement at Day Care and to provide their carers some respite.

Model of Service Provision

HMRS is staffed by one part-time coordinator (3 days per week) and direct care services are provided on a brokerage model, i.e. care workers are contracted as needed from other existing providers such as Uniting Care, Home Care and Extra Care, The Whiddon Group and NovaCare. The brokerage model has proven to be an efficient and effective model, as it enables the project to have a wider pool of workers to choose from and enables the service to better meet the cultural and linguistic needs of particular clients. The target group and Terms of Reference of the Multicultural Dementia Carer Support group was expanded to also include carers of people with a disability from a CALD background.

Services provided

Throughout 2011 a total of 26 clients received weekly services of between 2-8 hours per week, including transport for 2 clients- 8 clients attend 2-3 days per week. A total of 6 new clients commenced services since the beginning of this year and 7 clients ceased service mainly due to placement into permanent residential care and becoming frail, one passed away during the year due to illness. One client came back after months of absence due to behavioural issues which have been addressed with good medications management. All clients have been formally assessed initially and reviewed after 6 months of service. There are no clients on the waiting list and every client referred has been offered service.

In 2011 the Project has:

- Provided 10272 hours of service annually- about 15 hours per client per month
- contracted 20 care workers for direct service provision

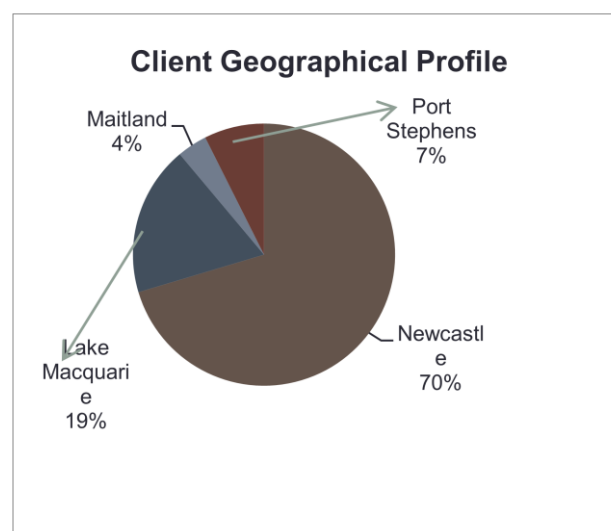
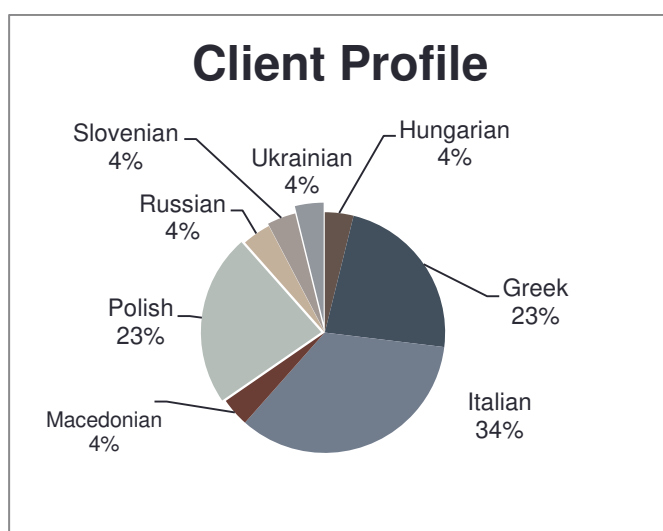
Table 1: Day Care Centres & Clients

Day Care Centre	No of clients per Day Care Centres at 30/10/2011
Allawah Day Centre, Wallsend	1
Cardiff Multicultural Friendship Group	2
Greek Day Care	3
Greek Holy Apostles Day Care	3
Italian Day Care	5
Macedonian Day Care	1
Maitland Multicultural Friendship Group	2
Polish Day Care	5
Southlakes Day Care, Morisset	1
Wattlegrove	3
TOTAL	26 clients

The majority of the clients live in the Newcastle LGAS, with a few from Lake Macquarie, Maitland and Port Stephens LGAS. Seventy three per cent are females and 23% males. The age ranges from 66 – 95 years of age and average age is 81

Table 2: Client Characteristics

Gender		Age				Client condition	
Male	Female	65-74	75-84	85-90	91+	Dementia	Frail Aged
7	19	4	14	5	3	12	14



Multicultural Dementia Support Group- support for carers

2011 Calendar was changed back to the 2nd Wednesday of the month to accommodate members who were not able to attend on Tuesday – to be reviewed again for 2012 activities. The service coordinates the monthly meeting of the group (jointly with Community Options) on the 2nd Wednesday of the month. Half way through the year Dominic Nyalis, who has been involved with the carers group since its inception, was no longer able to attend due to changing work priorities. We wish her well and thank her for all her assistance. Throughout the year we have had speakers and information sessions to assist and support carers, from the Educare, Hunter Valley Legal Advisory Centre, Centrelink, Financial Information Support Sector, Commonwealth Carer Respite Centre, Hunter New England Multicultural Health Team. Carers were treated to a Pamper Day in July at the Advanced School of Beauty Therapy which everyone enjoyed.

For Carers Week in October of this year we will be taking a bus trip to the Hunter Valley Gardens which promises to be the highlight of this year's calendar.

Administration

- An additional small grant from ADHC grant is being used for training and recruitment of volunteers and further operational assistance to carers and their families.
- Agreements and risk assessments of Day care Centres were updated throughout the year to follow up from ADHC Review/ Action plan
- MDS database was updated to the new HADS format and data successfully transferred / statistics compiled and sent to ADHC quarterly.

Training / conferences attended throughout the year include:

- Hunter & Central Coast HACC Training Project – “Using MDS data to tell your service story”
- Hunter New England Health – Changes in Memory Workshop
- Powerfully Productive Program (empowers workers to manage time effectively)
- Multicultural Expo – Newcastle Neighbourhood Centre
- HACC Workshop in Sydney - “Celebrating the Past”

Meetings attended on a regular basis include:

- Quality and Team meetings, Aged Care Team Monthly Meeting
- HACC services and Community Services Network quarterly meetings
- Dementia Interagency meetings & Upper Hunter Interagency

I would like to thank the Board and my colleagues at NSS for their assistance and support, which has enabled the service to consolidate and build successfully throughout 2011.



Community Visitors Scheme

Enza Di Stefano

Funded by Commonwealth Department of Health & Ageing

The Northern Settlement Services Community Visitors Scheme (CVS) provides socially isolated residents of aged care facilities in the Lower Hunter, who are from Culturally / Linguistically Diverse Backgrounds (CALD), a better quality of life through one to one volunteer visits. Over the past twelve months 18 Facilities have been visited with a total of 707 visits to 39 residents and 12,889 kilometres travelled. Over the past year five new referrals have been received of which four have been successfully placed.

Community Visitor Recruitment and Turnover:

Recruitment of CVS visitors is an on-going process and during the year 16 visitors were available and 4 new visitors have been recruited. Two are gentlemen from Chinese background -orientation/police checks completed and are on a waiting list for matching.

Five visitors visit more than one facility - due to the need of a specific language/ cultural background; and 4 visitors visit more than one resident (separately – on a one to one basis) at the same facility.

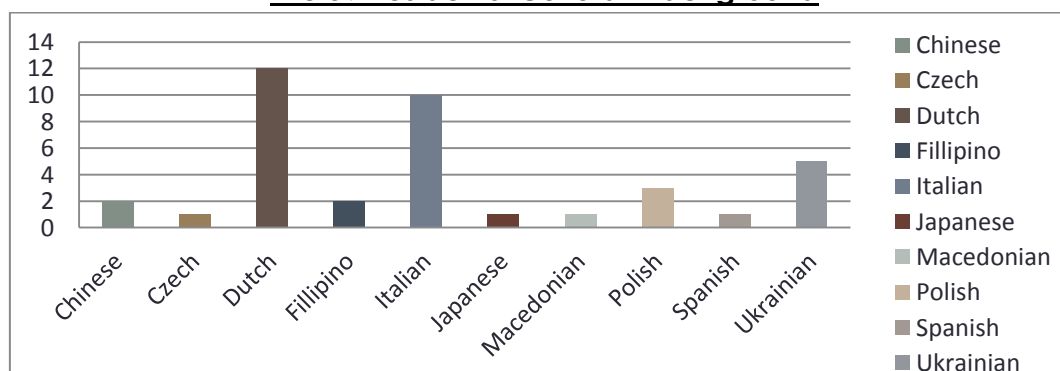
This CVS program is very fortunate to have longstanding volunteers, however two volunteers underwent major surgeries during the year which impacted on their capacity to visit whilst recuperating. One visitor ceased visiting as the resident has severe dementia. A volunteer who visits a resident with mental health issues, is not always able to be make visits on a regular basis - dependant on the wellbeing of the resident.

One visitor resigned due to moving outside of the area and 2 residents went to live with family overseas. This volunteer remains on the waiting list for a future match- 3 residents who had been receiving CVS for a number of years passed away.

In July 2010 a long standing visitor had a fall and broke her pelvis, sadly she passed away on 1st August and will be missed by all who had the privilege of knowing her.

An inaugural visitor of the CVS Program retired in August 2010, due to ill health. Very sadly she passed away in July 2011, she will be remembered for her enthusiasm, smile, warmth and generosity of heart (beautiful coloured and painted eggs given to her residents at Easter will not be forgotten).

The 39 Residents' Cultural Background



Orientation / Support Activities:

Conducted individual orientation for prospective visitors including Police Checks throughout the year as well as the three yearly renewal of police checks for 4 visitors. All visitors are regularly contacted (at least once a month) either through a phone call/email /mail to maintain communication and support. Support was given to a volunteer who had concerns for her resident who suffers badly from arthritis. Suggestions were given for activities to undertake together, as well as the Lifestyle Coordinator at the facility was contacted and she has now liaised with the visitor and suggested some activities.

Two visitors who underwent major surgeries were supported/visited by the co-ordinator; both volunteers have re-commenced visiting. The coordinator attended the funeral of a resident (visited for over 3 years) along with the visitor – this support was most appreciated by the visitor. The coordinator attended the funeral of a visitor – a small way to show one's last respects. The family was grateful of the coordinators presence.

The update of the CVS Coordinator Orientation Manual and Volunteer Job Description have been completed by the coordinator.

Promotional Activities:

The most successful promotion activities have proven to be the extensive and long standing contacts/good working relationships with local CALD communities/organisations/networks servicing a similar target group. Networking with other CVS auspices in the region continues with two referrals – both Chinese speaking visitors referred to NSS CVS program. One prospective volunteer of Anglo background has been referred to Mission Australia CVS Program. Whilst on an overseas holiday the coordinator recruited a volunteer for an Aged Care Facility in Perth - liaising with the Department, the Aged Care Facility/volunteer has been most pleasing and rewarding.

Multicultural Expo was attended in March 2011 – CVS pamphlets were distributed together with promotional NSS pens, water bottles etc. Over 100 people attended and much interest in the Program was shown. Medical Students from the John Hunter Hospital visited NSS and a presentation was given on CVS by the coordinator.

Networking:

Two regional CVS Network Meetings have been conducted over the past year- these meetings allow workers the opportunity to discuss issues of concern namely the “active visitor” definition, new CVS Guidelines, promotion of the CVS Program, alternate ways of recruiting volunteers/training options available. A Hunter Networking Meeting was an opportunity to discuss combined training sessions and support each other in promoting the CVS in facilities in the Upper Hunter.

Attended the CVS NSW/ACT State Forum -two engaging speakers presented on 'TARS and Advocacy services available in Aged Care Facilities' and 'Dementia and the wider implications'. It was disappointing that no representatives from the Department attended for the second consecutive year.

A request was received from Woodlands Lodge for participants to give a presentation depicting their cultural background for the facility's planned Multicultural month. A presentation on Holland was given by a wonderful CVS volunteer, and the Italian Junior School choir sang to a very appreciative audience.

Special Events:

Four major activities acknowledging the invaluable contribution the visitors make were conducted throughout the year.

- A lunch cruise on Lake Macquarie was held during Carers Week.
- The Christmas Thankyou Lunch- with a gift of a NSS 2011 pocket diary given to each visitor. All who attended enjoyed the company, games and delicious lunch.
- A Volunteer Bus Trip to NSW Art Gallery was a huge success- lunch, tour of the Terracotta Warriors exhibition/wander around the gallery made for a lovely day.
- National Volunteer Week Morning Tea was held "in house" in conjunction with the other NSS volunteer programs. 35 people attended/enjoyed the opportunity to interact with other volunteers from the organisation. Volunteers were presented with a National Volunteer Week Certificate of Appreciation.

Good News Stories:

Another Cultural Exchange has taken place at Kressville Lodge Hostel Cooranbong with a CVS volunteer presenting a display/talk on tulip time in Holland. The visitor and 2 other volunteers dressed in national costume distributed Dutch sweets - a resounding success with not only the residents but staff as well. Two long serving CVS Volunteers had an exposé of their volunteering life in the Newcastle Herald "Unsung Hero" weekly article. One of CVS long serving volunteers celebrated her **90th** birthday in May – this marvellous volunteer has the mind and energy of someone half her years. The flowers and card sent by NSS CVS were graciously received. I quote from the beautiful thankyou letter after describing the flower arrangement - "My heart still flutters when I look at it. One day they will have to go, but: every goodbye is the birth of a memory".

Benefits of the Scheme:

The principle benefit of the Scheme is that Visitors play an integral role in easing the social/cultural isolation experienced by many residents who may not have family living close by and whose extended support networks were left behind when they migrated.

Identified Difficulties:

The main difficulty remains the recruitment of suitable visitors from the diminishing ethnic population group who are an ageing population. This diminishing pool of visitors has necessitated adopting a useful and necessary strategy of a number of visitors seeing more than one resident in the same facility and often in different facilities.

The co-ordinator is planning to visit the Macedonian community and give a presentation on the CVS program. The presentation is not only to promote and recruit visitors but also to dispel any misinformation about the role of the volunteer. A request and discussion has taken place with the Department for a CVS pamphlet to be translated into the Macedonian language – to date not received from the Department.

Satisfaction with the Service Provided:

The feedback through both our networks and our direct relationship with the various aged care facilities indicates that the service provided is most appreciated and valued.



Multicultural Access Project - Hunter

Valerie Woodman

Funded by NSW Department of Family and Community Services, Ageing, Disability and Home Care (ADHC) - Home and Community Care Program (HACC)

The role of the regional MAP is to facilitate access of culturally and linguistically diverse (CALD) communities to HACC and related services and programs; provide input into service development and planning and support services to develop culturally competent practices. A core function is to research and report on the needs of the frail aged, younger people with a disability and carers from a CALD background in the Hunter to inform the planning process so that services are culturally appropriate and responsive to specific needs.

During the 2010/2011 the following initiatives were undertaken and outcomes achieved.

Consultation and Research

A business case was presented to ADHC Hunter to undertake CALD dementia research across the Hunter and Central Coast Region. The need to undertake this research was identified in the Hunter Dementia Care in the Community Action Plan 2009-2011.

Correspondingly a literature search found no evidence of current research or data on the incidence, knowledge and beliefs of CALD communities in the Hunter region on dementia. Research and consultation is needed to inform service planning/development in the Hunter and Central Coast Region to determine culturally appropriate and competent service models.

ADHC approved the expenditure of funds to facilitate the project and following a selective tender process NSS contracted Alt Beatty Consulting to undertake the research. The project commenced in June 2011 and timeframe for delivery of the final Report on findings is September 2011.

In partnership with the Central Coast MAP, research has also been ongoing during 2010/2011 in regard to the HACC bilingual workforce. The purpose of this research is to develop a language profile of workers who are bilingual or multilingual in the HACC service sector across the ADHC Hunter Region that encompasses the Hunter and Central Coast. The overall goal of the research is to increase the capacity and number of workers who are bilingual or multilingual in the HACC service sector. Initially the number of bilingual/multilingual staff and volunteers was mapped; followed by further investigation into factors underlying recruitment of bilingual employees with a CALD background. The study will guide the development of recommendations and strategies to increase the HACC bilingual/multilingual staffing pool (including volunteers) in order to provide equitable access to culturally appropriate support services. The final report on findings from this study will be available October 2011.

Service Support and Development

The MAP Hunter assisted with planning and staging the HACC "Hot Topics Forum" on 16 September held at Toronto Workers Club. The day was very successful with 109 service providers/board members from the Hunter and Central Coast attending. Evaluations from the event were very positive and a follow up forum is planned for 2011.

During September and October 2010 the MAP Worker was Acting Team Leader for the NSS Central Coast Office which involved some interim staffing adjustments and recruitment of a new Multicultural Social Support Co-ordinator.

MAP Hunter also provided input into submissions to the Productivity Commission Inquiry into Caring for Older Australians; firstly from the MAP Network (submitted by NSW Ethnic Communities Council) and secondly the HACC Development Officers Network submission (to ensure regional diversity issues were included).

On 18 January 2011 met with the Future Foods Project Officer NSW Meals on Wheels Association and the Central Coast MAP Worker to discuss issues around culturally appropriate meal options for HACC clients from a CALD background. It was agreed to continue to collaborate on developing strategies to increase food services knowledge of and access to a range of ethnic food suppliers. This was followed up at the NSW Meals on Wheels Association's Regional Conference at Newcastle Panthers on 31 May 2011. The conference was an opportunity to try several sources of pre-cooked meals; provide feedback regarding the food and it was heartening to see these included a good variety of cultural cuisine. It is anticipated that following several similar conferences across the state NSW Meals on Wheels Association would develop a listing of preferred suppliers.

Education and Training

In partnership with the South West Sydney MAP Worker, Bankstown Area Multicultural Network and the Manager Hunter New England Health Interpreter Service presented 'Working with Interpreters and Translators' training for community support services on 23 May 2011 at the ECC Centre Waratah. The training generated a lot of interest with 26 registrations and based on the number of inquiries will be run again in 2012.

Since going 'live' with our Broadband for Seniors Kiosk on 25 January 2011 NSS volunteer tutors have assisted 21 seniors (17 from a CALD background) to become computer literate and/or increased their computer skills. Feedback from seniors is very positive and the volunteer tutors are to be commended on their teaching skills and commitment to providing life-long learning opportunities.

Information and resources

Since commencing in the position the MAP Worker has been systematically compiling an electronic library of multicultural and multilingual resources which are available on request. The most sought information from mainstream services is for CALD demographic data. There is also a growing awareness by mainstream services of the need to become more culturally competent and inclusive in order to comply with the community Care Common Standards.

Presentations on NSS and the MAP have been delivered at interagency meetings across the Hunter including; Disability Services Network Hunter, Maitland HACC Forum, Port Stephens Interagency, Ethnic Communities Council (ECC) Day Care Co-ordinators meeting, Newcastle Lake Macquarie Community Care Network, Lower Hunter Community Care Network and Port Stephens East Community Care Network. Following these sessions many local service providers commented that they were not aware of the extent of services NSS provide and/or the challenges in supporting migrants and refugees.

The Aged Services Team participated and provided information on services at the Multicultural Services Expo held at the Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre on 23 March 2010 this was a very successful event with approximately 100 'show bags' distributed promoting NSS and an opportunity to network with other services.

The Multicultural Family Worker (Families First) and the MAP Worker promoted NSS at the Sibling Workshop (a seminar for families of children with a disability) organised by EduCare Support Service at Cardiff RSL on 3 May 2011. There was considerable interest in the services NSS provide from both parents and other service providers.

Strategic Planning

The MAP Hunter is a member of the CALD Service Planning Group, established and convened by ADHC Hunter Region which meets quarterly. The purpose of the group is to provide input on service planning and initiatives to support people from a CALD background such as the CALD Service Capacity Review Project Action Plan Hunter Region 2009-2011 and the Hunter Dementia Care in the Community Action Plan 2009-2011. This group also provides input (representing ADHC funded services) into the development of a regional strategic plan in line with ADHC Cultural Diversity Strategic Framework 2010-2013.

At the request of Port Stephens (PS) Council, facilitated a NSS submission identifying CALD issues relevant to the Port Stephens area and draft strategies to address them for inclusion in the PS Interagency Planning Document 2011-12.

The MAP Hunter also participates on the regional HACC Development Team convened by ADHC Hunter to support organisations and ensure a smooth transition for service providers from the current HACC system to the new Commonwealth and State arrangements.

Networks and Interagencies

The MAP Hunter represented NSS at the following networks and Interagencies:

MAP Network, Maitland HACC Forum, Upper Hunter Community Services Interagency, Lower Hunter Community Care Forum, Port Stephens (East) Combined Services Network, Port Stephens (West) Combined Services Network, PRIME7 'Our Community' Advisory Committee, Newcastle Lake Macquarie Community Care Services Network, Newcastle Multicultural Interagency, Hunter Rural Multicultural Network.



The
Broadband for Seniors
Kiosk & program
operated very successfully
from January 2011.





Refugee Support Team Leader
Kiri Hata

Overview:

The Refugee Support Team comprised of 11 staff who provided a wide range of settlement support services that centred on the settlement of humanitarian entrants in the Hunter Region and especially in Newcastle. Some changes occurred with the team as funding was directed to a broader refugee community and geographical base and as staff came and went. Support was given to refugees, especially those in vulnerable situations. Our refugee population derived from many countries, including South Sudan, Sudan, Burundi, Congo, Liberia, Mauritania, Rwanda, Sierra Leone, Uganda, Somalia, Ethiopia, and Ivory Coast as well as from Iraq, Iran and Afghanistan. The issues faced by the Refugee Team major settlement areas such as ongoing difficulties with accommodation, a growing problem as those here sought family reunion, and matters around family relationships, education, employment, legal and financial problems.

Project Work

Each Team member was linked to a specific project and these will be provided separately but the Team is to be congratulated for their work overall. Some of the project work focussed on particular groups or developments and the more well known of these were the work by Helen Buchan in developing the African Markets, the youth work of Tonkoh Kamara with the Real D a partnership project with the University, the Newcastle PCYC, other youth services such as the Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre's youth project and of course the wonderful work by our Refugee related Volunteers with the Home work Centres and the ongoing work of Penola House. At the mention of Penola House we cannot forget that much of our work owes greatly to the relationships that we have formed in partnership with other agencies. These include The Samaritans and the Brighter Futures work, the valuable working relationship we have with STARTTS, not only in the exacting face to Face counselling but also the various camps for young people including girls from a refugee background, TAFE and the AMEP and other courses it provides, Community Services, the Police, Centrelink the Multicultural Health unit and Refugee Health and others.

Finally, the Refugee Team was involved and represented together with other members of NSS staff in a range of different activities. These were events such as Australia Day at Lake Macquarie, Harmony Day at Blackbutt Reserve, various consultations with the Refugee Communities and Interagency Network meetings but especially with the Refugee Week Activities. Refugee Week saw 2 activities with a puppet show for kinder/Year1 held on 23rd June and had 250 participants and the second was a road trip to Manning Valley on 29th June with 28 refugee youth and 150 Taree HS participants. It was a good year and requires a big thank you to the Refugee Team and NSS as a whole.





Refugee Communities Project

Nellie Srisurapon

Funded by Department of Immigration & Citizenship

-under the Settlement Grants Program

This project provided service to all refugee/ humanitarian entrants throughout the Hunter who have resided in Australia for less than 5 years. This position was a continuation from a previous SGP worker and was for 3 days per week.

In the reporting period 58 new clients were registered to our service. The majority of our clients were serviced at our NSS office and also in the Mayfield /Waratah areas.

Service users came from 17 different countries, with the most coming from Burundi, Sudan, Dinka(Sudan), Liberia, Mauritania , Rwanda, Uganda and the Congo.

As our networks are growing stronger throughout the Hunter there has been an increase in referrals from both government and non government sectors. The referrals include John Hunter Hospital, TAFE NSW, Legal Practitioners, Accommodation Providers, Internal Referral, Charity organisations and Centrelink. The majority of referrals though have been self referral or through family and friends.

ISSUE	Instance of Service	Client Referral (outgoing)	Group	Attendees
Immigration	35	4		
Education	66	18		
Housing	93	27		
Employment	17	4		
Income Support	79	36		
Mental Health	31	8		
Domestic Violence	48	8		
Legal	85	12	1	6
Court Assist	21	6		
Police	12	6		
Family Problems	35	13		
Settlement	67	17		
Health	91	18		
Home visit/ outside assist	42			
Transport	13	3		
Document assist	17			
Charity Assistance	8	8		
Electricity Assistance	28		1	28
Letters of Support	22			
TOTAL	810	177	2	34

INTERPRETERS:

T.I.S. accessed **22** instances. Languages include **Pular, Kirundi, Dinka, Arabic, Susu, Swahili, Kiswahili and Farsi.**

TRAINING:

OH&S training, DOH workshop – “Rent it, Keep it”, Law for Non Lawyers, Shivani Training, Crisis/Trauma/Grief training, Child Restraint Training, DIAC SGP Training.

MEETINGS:

6 Caseworker meeting, **5** partner agency caseworker meetings, **2** Centrelink meetings, **4** Handover meetings with ACL.

HIGHLIGHTS:

- Domestic Violence Breakfast – raising awareness of DV
- Legal / paying fines awareness session for African Youth
- NSS - Australia Day Stall
- DIAC SGP Rural Conference
- Energy Workshop with Dept. of Environment and Heritage.

CHALLENGES:

- Continued issue of failure to use interpreters for clients. Relying on NSS to arrange interpreters. GP's not accessing Priority Line.
- Not enough intensive intervention and support by agencies when client has been referred on, resulting in complex issues arising and families being torn apart.
- Some clients initial settlement needs not met when handed to SGP worker by IHSS provider.
- Insufficient housing, high rent and insensitive rental agents.

Another year has flown by with many sad faces coming to see us and mostly smiling ones leaving. This year was mad, with work frantic at times but very satisfying with mostly good outcomes. Still waiting for departments and agencies to catch up!

I would like to thank all NSS staff and the “great “ Refugee team.



Refugee Communities Project (Burundi)

Joselyne Ntahomvukiye

Funded by Department of Immigration & Citizenship
-under the Settlement Grants Program

CLIENT ISSUES AND GENERAL FAMILY SUPPORT

The number of refugees and families in the Newcastle area from Burundi, Rwanda and Congo communities was 29 families.

Client issues are listed in the Table below. One of these, accommodation, was a real challenge. Also the accommodation was often in private rental and was more expensive. This caused 3 families to relocate to other States to find affordable accommodation. Another major client contact need was with Employment and the difficulties posed were such that of the 17 people seeking employment in Newcastle during this year, only four were successful. Other issues were the relationships with friends, education, childcare, health and issues around language including needing to access interpreters.

Table 1: Client Issues

Problems / Issues	Face to face	Telephone
Immigration and proposing relatives	18	11
Employment issues	53	27
Education and training issues	51	44
Learning English	28	4
Housing and accommodation	28	16
Health issues	44	15
Mental health	6	7
Childcare	50	6
Youth issues	22	1
Parenting issues	22	1
Legal issues	4	0
Police	6	6
Translation of document	0	0
Transport issues	19	4
Filling in forms	26	2
Culture information	29	0
Dealing with friends	291	875
Language problem	314	163
Needing an interpreter	272	36
Budgeting	81	8
Bills issues	39	2
Separation issues	18	0
Passport	12	0
Banks	14	1
Reading a letter	36	0
Home visit	43	0
Total	1526	1229

OTHER ACTIVITIES

The Burundi, Rwanda and Congolese communities have participated in all programs offered through NSS. They attended in a food handling course and are involved in African Training Markets at Hamilton plaza. They have cooked hot traditional food, and sold fresh traditional food produce. It was good for these communities to learn new skills like how to run a market. Activities for men, women and children continued to improve the families' integration into the wider community.

They also attended information sessions from DIAC on being a proposer for someone who is member of your family and from the Smith Family on the "Save Plus Program", which educates families about budgeting and how to save money for their children's education. This last information session helped the communities to develop their financial, planning and budgeting skills as well as the importance of goal setting, needs and wants, keeping a spending diary, generating extra money and having an annual money planner. In another session from Centrelink at Penola House, they learned about how Centre Pay works, the types of payments and what can happen if you don't keep Centrelink informed of changes to your activities.

They have also been doing the Families in Cultural transition (FICT) training organized by STARTTS. As part of the FICT program, they discussed settling in new place, finding support services, living with youth, parenting, how to use TIS, domestic violence, Trauma and Healing and budgeting. The women attended a sewing class at Penola house.

The Burundian and Rwandan women and girls practice their dancing at Penola House once a week. The Youth from Burundian community with other youth from other communities went to visit Taree High school to connect with students and share experiences/stories, outlining where they come from, why they left their country and life in Australia. The Burundi women group performed at different places for harmony days, at school, Aged Care facilities and neighbourhood centre, to help empower their community & engage with the mainstream.



PHOTOS:
Local Refugee Youth travelled to meet Taree High School students for an exchange of stories, experiences, performance & sport for **Refugee Week 2011**





Youth Project

Tonkoh Kamara

Funded by Department of Immigration & Citizenship
-under the Settlement Grants Program

The aim of the project is to identify and address issues face by young people aged 12-24 years from humanitarian and migrant background within the Newcastle LGA, with outreach to Maitland and Lake Macquarie LGA's. The position aims to improve youth participation in programs and increase their access to services, and to develop responses to gaps in youth services provision, especially to new, small and emerging communities.

The youth worker's main role in this project is the provision of support through information, referral, casework, advocacy, mentoring, service planning and development and capacity building to help youth from humanitarian and migrant background in their settlement needs. The project also participated in local and regional youth and community networks.

Recreational Activities

The worker has developed and supported a range of sporting, recreational and community activities for young migrants and humanitarian entrant during 2010 - 2011, which have been and still is a great method of encouraging youth participation in community activities, assisting with their integration into Australian life, improving self-confidence and developing life skills. These include:

- Migrant youth soccer teams (The Hunter Simba FC) which has participated in in the Northern district Football competition friendly matches against mainstream teams at the TAFE ground.
- Supporting and always present for youth weekly activities at Newcastle Police & Citizen's Youth Club (PCYC), eg. gymnasium, boxing, weightlifting, etc and also the PCYC basketball team and at Hamilton South Community Centre (run by Samaritans Foundation), eg. social activities, table-tennis, pool table, video games, etc.
- Youth camp and excursions in partnership with STARTTS Recreation Officer.
- Weekly Youth dancing groups from diverse background such as Iran, Iraq, Russian, Afghan, West African, Sudanese and Burundi at the NSS.
- School holiday Youth Activity at the PCYC every school term in partnership with the LOFT, Samaritans, The big issue (street soccer), Hunter New England Health (Youth mental health project) and various schools in the Newcastle LGA.

Youth Employment

The youth project in trying to increase the chances of youth employability, work in partnership with other community organisations, training organizations and job networks. An example of such partnership is **the REAL D program** for youth which was launched last year and has been funded this year by the University of Newcastle. Out of the 14 young people attending Try-trade workshops, trade expositions, forums -three boys have been selected to attend the annual five days camping (Last week of school - Dec 2011) of the 'LIVE IT' program organised by the University of Newcastle.

Education & Training

The numbers of youth enrolled at various educational and training institutions in Newcastle and the Hunter region has increased. The youth project has also increased its presence in schools and involvement in other community programs. Examples are regular support, meetings with school authorities, parent and organised sessions on cultural awareness and educational pathways all aiming to assist in the integration of newly arrived young people into the mainstream community.

The project has outreached to following schools with large numbers of young people from humanitarian and migrant background students; St. Pius High School (Adamstown), St. Francis Xavier in Hamilton, Lambton High, San Clemente High (Mayfield), Waratah technology campus and will start at Newcastle High school during term one 2012. These visits aim to mentor, advocate and build confidence and self-esteem in students, and to break down communication barriers between these students, their parents and school staff. The youth project did some information sessions, one of which was organised on the 29th of June 2011 during the refugee week celebration trip to Taree High School. It was attended by about 100 young people from the school and some 20 from the Newcastle African youth group who shared experiences with their Taree counterparts. Issues such as cultural shock, awareness and change, basic transaction skills and sporting skills were discussed and demonstrated.

Table 1: Migrant Youth Project.

Clients in the Newcastle, Lake Macquarie and Maitland area, during the 2010-2011 reporting period;

Sudanese	57%
Liberian	12%
Sierra Leone	1%
Burundian	7%
Congolese	18%
Mauritanian	3%
Iraqi	1.5%
Afghanis	0.5%

Table 1 indicates the numbers of young people that the project has worked with from all humanitarian and migrant communities in the Newcastle and Hunter Regions. Sudanese young people were the largest group with 57% of all clients being Sudanese. There has been a slight increase in the number young people from Sudan accessing the service due mainly because of the success of NSS youth programs, as well as some client relocation away from the area. The good relationship this project has with schools and community services provides relatively easy access to the client group.

In conclusion, this project has been able to support young people from humanitarian and migrant communities in a range of activities, as well as focus on and support other agencies in the direct need of migrant and humanitarian young people. It has also assisted with the development of strategies to support youths and to encourage these youths to have self-esteem and support themselves.



Life Skills & Parenting Groups

Helen Buchanan

Funded by Department of Immigration & Citizenship and
Department of Families & Housing, Community Services & Indigenous Affairs

Objectives of the program:

- To work with those families that is identified as most vulnerable within the migrant and refugee community.
- To facilitate humanitarian entrants in developing satisfying lives within the Australian society.
- To create independent living skills with individuals and family groups
- To develop relationships and parenting skills for youth who self-parent and parent young siblings
- To capacity build with individuals and groups various life skills and parenting skills
- To encourage independent thinking with problem solving in relation to family and community
- To encourage understanding and acceptance of the different rules and customs in relationship to family and wider society
- To encourage openness about cross cultural issues and conflicts
- To provide a forum to develop new life and parenting skills
- To enable cross referrals within our service and other services

Groups running:

1. African Refugee Training Markets and program
2. Burundi women's group
3. Sudanese women's group
4. Equatorian women's group
5. Acholi women's group
6. Liberian community group
7. Youth groups/activities (holiday program)
8. Toddler & Children's story, dance & song group
9. African men's group
10. First chance early childhood program and mentoring of community women (pictured)
11. African men's fund raising BBQ
12. Individual client consults & family skills building via casework as required



This year our program has focused around developing more African groups and refining the skills of those involved in the African Refugee Training markets. We work closely with all the African Humanitarian groups and the concept of language and customer relations is developing rapidly. There is also greater involvement in festival planning and participation alongside conference and cultural expos. This development provides a better understanding of not only specific skills required by our client groups but also in educating the wider community on the vastness and differences of the various African culture groups.

We have developed booklets with photos of our programs and our African Cultural recipe books. Our food, personal and family hygiene practices have extended into understanding greater concepts about environmental issues of waste and contamination alongside community immunity and that of vulnerable life cycle groups such as elderly, and those on medical governed issues like chemotherapy and those with allergies.

The planning undertaken for the training markets has been able to be transferred into family matters and social planning. Some of the community groups are almost at the stage to operate independently so many of our goals are being met in wonderful ways that we could not have imagined. Obtaining a Council license, managing insurance for events, being able to acquire registration with food authorities and involving other organizations in event participation has been part of this year's training. Helen has also been able to obtain a food safety supervisors certificate to enable NSS to meet Government regulations around the Training markets.

Our groups continue to assist in the development of the youth. They provide feedback which is useful to improving programs for them over the holiday periods. We have a core of youth who actively participate and have built much needed relationships with workers from various organisations such as CAMS, Interrelate, Children's food programs for healthy eating and FPA on personal youth health matters that are essential for emerging puberty, bike maintenance and safe bike riding, picnics with kids and painting programs, swimming, making Christmas cards and presents are all a part of our skills development. We value and appreciate support from many agencies in this work and especially that from our various Councils.

In our programs we have met the need of over 300 participants in various ways and over 1000 general community contacts.

To date, we have held the following markets in James St Plaza in Beaumont St;
April, July, September, December



Left:
Preparing food for the Markets



Right:
Bike Maintenance & Safety Youth
Holiday Program

Right: The Training Markets, James Street Plaza Hamilton, are an interface for the community to connect with our refugee clients.





Parenting Support Project

Zenaida Edmunds

Funded by Department of Families & Housing, Community Services & Indigenous Affairs

The service provides parenting support for mothers with newborn babies, and teen-age mothers from refugee, humanitarian entrants and from culturally and linguistically (CALD) background families, who are identified as disadvantaged, isolated, vulnerable and families at risk. These families are experiencing hardships, effects of torture and trauma, domestic violence, alcohol abuse, physical and psychological crisis in their settlement and in their lives.

Parenting support includes; individual support, referrals, group activities and information sessions and the project is funded for 7 hours a week. With the limited number of hours, the weekly sessions is held one morning a week.

The number of families accessing the service on a regular basis during the 12 month period totals 11 from Congolese, Burundi, Sudanese, Somalia, Chinese, Thai, and Japanese backgrounds. Other families access the service as a one off for advice and referrals.

Activities:

Mothers and Newborn Group – meets every Tuesday mornings.

Group Work:

Activities provided include weekly sessions and information sessions.

Activities during the sessions provide practical activities that mothers are able to do at home with their babies to support attachment and enhance the baby's development.

Positive interactions with babies through music and movement using simple songs are very popular with the mothers. The sessions are informal, utilizing mothers practical experiences and also informative.

The project has supported the establishment of a Japanese playgroup, at Penola House utilizing the Moocastle room, the aim in establishing the playgroup is to support the children's home language. The session was held every Wednesday mornings, until December of last year, the parents were looking for another venue that is central for everyone.



Table 1. Issues Presented:

Issues	Face to Face	Telephone/email
Childcare	9	7
Child's Nutrition	9	6
Children's Allergies	7	7
Baby's Sleeping Pattern	15	6
Accessing medical services	11	9
Language	9	5
Breastfeeding/Bottle Feeding	10	5
Screening for babies	11	6
Family and Relationships	7	7
Children's Services	12	9
Employment opportunities	15	7
Child Development	11	10
Transport	10	11
Language support	9	12
Housing/Accommodation	7	11
Total	152	118

Activities / Topics Include:

- Rhythm and Music – Movement
- Tummy Time – Muscle development
- Diet/ Nutrition
- Allergies and Introduction of Solids
- Hearing and Speech
- Baby Massage
- Body Awareness / Muscle Tone
- Language / Reading

**Achievements / Outcomes:**

Approximately 90% of mothers attending the sessions have knowledge of;

- Providing their babies with appropriate care, positive attachments and using suitable toys and activities.
- Accessing mainstream support and services independently.
- Using stories and reading books to their babies and using their own home language.



Family Support Project (Congolese)

Kwabo Batende

Funded by the Department of Immigration & Citizenship
-under the Settlement Grants Program

This position provides support services to the Congolese Community in its settlement in Newcastle and was established in October 2010. The activities of the Congolese Supporter Worker have been wide ranging and included: housing, provision of general information, employment, education and training, sport and linking community members to migration assistance,

As a Family Supporter Worker the project worker visited the families and supported families to access accommodation. This included helping families to apply to the public housing. Today families have been placed on the Housing Waiting list and others are on the priority list. In addition, NSS has also been able to find accommodation for around 7 families in Newcastle and Lake Macquarie. Further, through NSS the Congolese community was provided with training sessions related to the maintaining housing with information on the Australian rent system, cleaning your house, what is a bond, health, etc.

Employment has also been difficult for the Congolese new arrivals as they do not speak English. Despite this, the project worker and other supporting staff of NSS were able to contact different industries and some Congolese have found work locally. Education and training sessions for Congolese families have been provided in different programs including Families in Culture Transition: The aim of this session was to inform the Congolese community how to deal with people from other cultures that live together in Australia. Several health sessions were undertaken with mothers about their children's immunisation and the purpose of vaccination and first aid at home with young children, while fathers had a session on how Australian schools work. We also provided information regarding the different alternatives in disciplining children, approaches that were very different from where most came from. Home visits are also conducted to support families by providing information related to school education, hospital, religion, cultures etc.

This Congolese family worker provided bilingual assistance to the NSS migrant agents when providing services and support for Congolese and Rwandese clients including submitting visa application. Bilingual support was also provided when working with some agencies to resolve bill payments (electricity, gas, and phone), filling school application forms and dealing with Real Estate Agents, etc.

Work also focussed on sport and involving young people in organised activities. With the support of the NSS we tried to organise a team for young adolescents. This was a good pathway to support youth be part of the larger Australian community and training and football games supported by NSS in TAFE ground are regular. Some of the young Africans are now playing and going ahead and many have been selected in the major clubs of Newcastle. Activities have also been created for children of Congolese families to participate to camps activities, bus trips, BBQ and picnics.

Meeting – ceremonies

Congolese cultural community meetings and ceremonies were held at NSS. In this year the Congolese community had organised two general meetings that were supported by NSS. This is not only an opportunity for the community to come together but also the way to learn more about Australia. As the Congolese community has grown, the approximately attendance can be 50 to 70 people.

Integration is always a long process and so difficult. It is hoped that despite these difficulties that our Congolese clients how this project is working it is responding to the issues and needs of the clients and is helping clients to learn how to solve problem themselves to facilitate their integration in this region.

Congolese Activities throughout this period include:



Photos:
Culture In Transition-
session





Volunteer Co-ordination Program

Michael Freund (Educational Programs)

Funded by Department of Immigration & Citizenship
- Settlement Grants Program (SGP)

Georgina Ramsay /Emilie Wiggers (Welfare Programs)

Funded by Northern Settlement Services Limited

The purpose of this position is to co-ordinate assistance for NSS refugee clients from people in the wider Newcastle community, through a range of volunteering programs.

The main job tasks are to: log requests for assistance from refugees, then recruit, register, police-check and match suitable volunteers to those requests. The specific activities of volunteers are then arranged with the refugee individual/family at a placement meeting, or at a program induction. Ongoing support is provided for all volunteer-client placements.

Volunteer Recruitment

Continual recruitment of new volunteers was again critical to the success of all volunteer programs. Recruitment was aided considerably by promoting our specific volunteering needs with the following services: University of Newcastle – Teach Outreach, iLEAD, and Careers Service; Hunter Volunteer Centre; NSS Volunteers website & mailing list.

Volunteer Registration

Each new volunteer was given an induction to NSS, including information about our organisation, services, locations, volunteering programs & policies, as well as background & cultural information on our refugee clients. New volunteers registered by completing several forms: 1) Volunteer Policy-Agreement; 2) Volunteer Information; 3) Prohibited Persons Employment Declaration; 4) National Criminal History Record Check. A photo also taken of each new volunteer, for Administration to make up the ID badge.

Table 1: Volunteer Statistics for 2010-11

Volunteer Status	Vols.	% change from 2009-10
Enquiries received	304	+24%
Registered	134	-9%
Placed in Program	226	+21%
Re-started or Extended	88	+54%
Inactive (known)	138	+10%
Withdrew (known)	16	-72%

Table 1 (left) shows the volunteer statistics for the reporting year.

As at 30 June 2011, a total of about 175 registered volunteers were actively working in client programs, or awaiting placement. The main volunteering programs with numbers of participants are described below:

Homework Centre (HWC): 93 volunteers participated

The HWC program continued to operate extremely successfully at our four partner schools: Hamilton Public School, St. Pius High School, San Clemente High School, Waratah Technology Campus. Each HWC was managed by a Co-ordinator, employed by NSS. An average of 35 volunteers consistently attended HWC each week to provide one-to-one or group tutoring.

A total of around 75 refugee students participated overall, with an average of 50 students consistently attending HWC each week. These students would not have been able to receive this kind of regular assistance with homework, assignments, reading, etc. from their parents/guardians because of their limited English skills. Also, parent information sessions were successfully held at Hamilton (feedback on student progress) and St. Pius (information on transition to Yr. 11). The HWC project was specifically funded by DIAC/SGP, with additional donations received from Clubs NSW. *(Update: New funding was received from DIAC for 2011-12.)*

In-Home Tutoring: 34 volunteers participated

Volunteers provided support with homework, assignments, reading, etc. for students one-on-one, in the client home or local library. Students ranged from infants to primary to high school level.

Volunteers in Schools Program (VISP): 13 volunteers participated

Volunteers provided in-class support for students one-on-one, at various local primary & secondary public schools as part of VISP. This program is administered by DET Refugee Support Officer, Renata Ninevski, who ran induction sessions for volunteers, and also facilitated their school placements.

Penola House: 74 volunteers participated

Penola House volunteers assisted a men, women, and child clients from a variety of backgrounds with a broad range of activities and programs, which included: office/reception, child minding, rental/accommodation support, gardening, and various other special projects. Child minding was the busiest program to utilise volunteers at Penola House this year. Food Safety and Handling programs, run by Helen Buchanan, also continued to be a success with involvement from many volunteers.

Driving Supervision: 25 volunteers participated

Volunteers supervised learner driver clients to log the 120 hours necessary to apply for their 'P' licence. NSS volunteers enabled six clients to pass their 'P' test and get their licence, whilst a number of clients and volunteers continue to participate in this program to work towards this goal. The continuation of the NSS driving volunteer program which utilises the Penola House car, allowed a number of clients to learn driving skills and log hours without having access to their own car.

Adult English Literacy: 37 volunteers participated

Adult English literacy assistance was the busiest single program for Welfare volunteers this year. Volunteers provided English language support for adults, one-on-one in the family home, at NSS, at Penola House, etc. Citizenship preparation was also provided.

General Home / Family / Transport: 25 volunteers participated

Volunteers provided support within the homes of some client families, providing ongoing assistance in activities such as childcare, shopping assistance, transport, and family support.

Miscellaneous / Events: 35 volunteers participated

Volunteers assisted with one-off projects and activity days. A particular success was volunteer participation in the African Refugee Training Markets organised by Helen Buchanan. Additionally, volunteers were utilised to provide mentoring support to clients; to assist with school holiday activities held at Penola House; to provide childminding support for Miza Torlakovic's group programs at Ethnic Communities Council; to provide mentoring and supervision at the Young Women's Camp in school holidays; and to assist with one-off clean-up days for clients moving out of homes or needing assistance to prepare for rental inspections.

Community Volunteer Awards

Four long-serving NSS volunteers were nominated for the 2011 Newcastle Community Volunteer Awards, which is organised by the office of Sharon Grierson MP (Newcastle). The volunteers will attend the presentation ceremony later in the year to receive their well-deserved awards. Another long-serving NSS volunteer was nominated and received an award from Jill Hall MP (Shortland).

**Staffing**

Emile Wiggers will replace Georgina from August 2011, for the 2 days a week role. We welcome her to the team.

Acknowledgements

A massive thank-you goes to all of our wonderful volunteers, who are the life-blood of our refugee support programs. NSS recognised their valuable contributions this year by hosting a special Morning Tea in National Volunteer Week (May), and by sending each volunteer a gift and personalised certificate at Christmas time.

Michael especially wishes to thank Volunteers Co-ordinator colleague, Georgina, for her dedication, hard work and team focus in the Welfare Programs role since Feb. 2010 - we wish Georgina all the best with her new casework position.

Thanks also to the other Refugee Support Team workers and NSS office staff. We look forward to working with such great people next year, in supporting our refugee clients.



Filipino Welfare Project

Petrona Kelly

Funded by NSW Community Services

This project provides support services to highly disadvantaged Filipino people, mainly women and children who are experiencing physical and psychological crisis and hardship through domestic violence, homelessness, mental health and isolation, immigration issues and other misfortunes encountered in their settlement.

And as I reflect at this time, I realise the successes and challenges of the service we do. However, the continued complexity of the job strengthened us even better.

Working 4 days per week, from 1st July 2010 to June 2011, there were approximately 1,277 issues/needs of clients. Their issues are inter-related in many cases and on many occasions, a client presented a number of needs/problems. The issues faced by clients are described in the following table:

Problem/Issues	No. of Instances	Problems/Issues	No. of Instances
Domestic violence	117	Income Support & Finances	95
Immigration & Citizenship	130	Overseas Qualifications	28
Housing & Accom	98	Settlement Information	223
Family Problem	80	Aged Care	20
Health/Mental Health	70	Education & Training	45
Legal Matters	75	Childcare	25
Youth Issues	65	Police	15
Employment	28	General Information	45
Learning English	18	Other	100
		Total:	1,224

Other needs include social/emotional, death/bereavement, separation and divorce, gambling problem, harassment, discrimination, neighbourhood dispute, income tax returns, supporting letters, resumes, transport difficulties, social isolation, cultural information, language difficulties, filling forms, access to belongings, landlord dispute, translations of documents, lost and passport renewals, referee, JP signatures, material assistance, travel infringements, court support, etc.

Services Provided: Advocacy, counselling, referral & information, consultation (to & from), filling of forms, letters of support, referee, hospital/home visits, interpreting, document translation, court support, transport assistance, cultural information, JP signatures, etc.

One of the Key Service Specifications of this project is the provision of community information or education to raise awareness, issues, services and activities and during the year sessions were organised for the community on legal issues such as AVO's, Power of Attorney, Guardianship, Wills, Property Settlement, separation & divorce, domestic violence; foster care information session, mental health, depression, healthy hearts, high blood pressure, first aids; and superannuation & finances.

Networking & Training:

During the year, I maintained networking with peers and colleagues and other service providers to further develop my skills and enhance information level to better serve the needs of the Filipino community by attending the following trainings, meetings, seminars, etc: NSS Caseworkers, NSS Team Leaders, NSS AGM, NSS Planning Day, Centrelink Multicultural Forums, Elimination of Violence Against Women, OH & Safety trainings, White Ribbon Breakfast, Child Protection Breakfast, HPTCLAS Committee meetings, Keep Them Safe Training Putting It Into Practice Workshop, Northern Disability Services Opening Day, Lake Macquarie Council Australia Day Planning meetings, Harmony Day Celebrations (Cessnock & Singleton), Conference on Family Law Changes & Their Impact, Rent It Keep It (Housing NSW), CSGP Reform (Service System Realignment), NOVA Management Committee meetings, Energy Australia Forum, Australia Day (Speers Point), Child Car Seat Restraint Workshop, Identifying & Responding to Risk of Harm of Children & Young People, OH & S Session on Risk Assessments for Events, Fire & Evacuation, Newcastle Family Referral service Launch, AON Information session, Hep A, B, C & HIV Information Session.

Other Activities:

As the Team Leader of NSS Welfare Team I have co-ordinated and organised monthly caseworkers meetings and summarised the team's monthly individual reports. I also completed the NSS Service Specification & Achievement Performance Reports of NSS projects such as the Russian, Thai, Tongan, Samoan and Filipino to the funding body, Dept. of Community Services.

Being an accredited member and registered social worker with the Australian Association of Social Workers (AASW), I can complete Statutory Declarations (DIAC Form 1040) of people on domestic violence situations and who are applying for permanent residency in Australia. This period, I was able to assist 6 women from the Philippines, Thailand, Nepal and India gain their permanent residency including three young children from the Department of Immigration & Citizenship. Likewise, a male from the Philippines was also granted PR due to proven abuses he experienced from his Australian wife.

I also co-ordinated the *Filipino Choir of Newcastle* for rehearsals and performances, as well the *Filipino Women's Group*. We meet every Friday.

Summing up, this project has been very effective in building excellent partnership with a full range of service providers such as community housing, women's & children's refuges, family support services, childcare centres, social workers from hospitals/schools, Centrelink, Multicultural Health, Community Services, youth services, etc. to improve the lives of Filipinos in the Hunter, especially women with young children who were in crisis situations. This is the last report for this project, due to changes to the program from the funding body.

I would like to thank my colleagues for their continued support and encouragement. A special thanks to Violetta Walsh for all the years of support & guidance. Warm thanks to Lulu and the NSS Board for their unending support, of the Filipino Welfare Project.



Brighter Futures Program

Zenaïda Edmunds

Funded by Department of Human Services, Community Services Agency
- Early Intervention Program

The Brighter Futures Program (BF) is an early intervention support to vulnerable children and families at risk. The support involves case management to address all areas of family vulnerability. The type of support could be access to child care, parenting, social, health and education to achieve positive outcomes for children and for families.

The target group for the BF program is: families who have child/children 8yrs old or younger, or expecting a child, with priority given to families with children under 3 yrs of age, has stable accommodation living in Newcastle and Lake Macquarie areas.

The BF Program in Newcastle and Lake Macquarie area is a collaboration of government and non- government agencies that delivers the program to families and Samaritans Foundation is the lead agency.

Northern Settlement Services (NSS) delivers the program to families from culturally and linguistically (CALD) background, who are willing to participate in the program through home visitation, and in close consultation with the assigned BF Case Manager from Samaritans Foundation. The NSS Brighter Futures CALD Home visitor is funded for 14 hours a week.

The role of the BF home visitor is to visit the family at least once a week to support the family achieving the goals mutually agreed by the BF program and the family. It is building skills and capacity of the family and includes positive family relationship, also referring families to external services such as parenting programs, financial counseling, child behavioural clinic, nutrition, homework support, life skills, general health and hygiene of children, and providing general support, etc.

This year I have been home visiting 3 families from Liberia, Burundi and Australian Aboriginal background.

Total No. of Home Visits: 130 visits

Total No. of Visiting Hours: 365 hours and 30 minutes



Issues addressed:

Issues	No. of Incidence	Face /Face	Telephone / Email
Child Care Placement	3	6	10
Playgroup Access	4	5	4
Diet / Nutrition	5	11	7
Health / Hygiene	5	15	18
Behavioral Problems	3	15	10
Housing	2	6	10
Financial Difficulties	3	7	5
Family Relationships	3	6	5
Bullying - school	3	7	5
School Enrollment	3	3	9
School Camp	2	2	5
School Fees	3	7	10
Sports – Soccer Club	1	6	11
Homework Support	3	15	5
English Language Support	3	7	5
Immunization	4	5	7
Housekeeping / Cleaning	3	11	
After School Activities	5	15	
Filling –In Forms	26	26	
Reading letters/ School Newsletters	17	17	
Parent / Teacher Interviews	7	7	15
Settling Newborn Babies	2	6	5
Social/ Community Participation	3	7	10
Total	113	212	156

The work involves organizing and taking the children and family to appointments such as dietician, paediatrician, psychologist, dental clinic, doctors and also organizing meetings with school principals, and case workers meetings to provide a holistic support to a child. I also assist families with transport, referral to financial counselor and registering them to places such as "Food for Life" to be able to buy cheaper groceries.

Other activities are monthly meetings with other BF workers from various agencies, training, monthly reporting and monthly data collection of number of visits to families and the number of hours. Attendance and participation in relevant training, workshops and conferences has been very beneficial in my work.

I would like to thank my colleagues for their ongoing support and encouragement, to the NSS Board, for their dedication to the worthy cause that we all do.



Multicultural Family Support Project (Families First)

Miza Torlakovic

Funded by Families NSW

The culturally and linguistically diverse (CALD) specific Family Project under Families NSW provides support to vulnerable disadvantaged families comprising of first time parents and families with children aged 0-8 from CALD backgrounds. The target group includes teenage parents and parents with a developmental disability and/or parents with other special needs who live in the Newcastle and Lake Macquarie LGAs.

Families NSW introduced a new way of collecting data through an on-line data collection system which has two six months data collection period -1 July - 31 December and 1 January – 30 June. This year, 84 families were supported by this project and when children are included this comprise a total of 208 people. The table below shows how this project compares to other NSW Family projects

The NSS Family Project compared to other NSW Family Project figures

Type of families	NSS CALD Family project (%)	NSW Average (%)
Aboriginal Families	1 %	26.5%
Language other than English	100%	40.5%
Young parents	25%	23.5%
Sole parents	27.5%	38%
Socio Economically disadvantaged families	99%	68%
Rural/ remote families	7.5%	28.5%
Disability/ special needs	9%	12%

Based on Families NSW Online Data for July – December 2010 and January – June 2011.

As can be seen above, the client group varies having single parents, young parents, etc. It is also varied with no particular dominant migrant or refugee group. Families come from 30 different backgrounds including: Iran, Bangladesh, India, Congo, Sudan, Zimbabwe, Croatia, Bosnia, Filipinos, Spain, Chile, Serbia, Iraq, Saudi Arabia, Japan, Indonesia, Pakistan, Jordan, Sierra Leone, Macedonia, Burundi, Afghanistan, Peru, Bulgaria, Turkish, Nigeria, Korea, Nepal, Taiwan, and Thailand.

Referrals came from various services -Hunter Area Health, Women's refuges, Child Care Services, Child and Family Health, Mental Health Services, Housing services, TAFE, Schools and Legal services. They also came through community services, other early intervention services, as well as internally through other NSS workers. The project also accepted clients who were self-referred.

Group Work

This year, this project started MOMS (Mothers, Obstetrics and Multicultural Support) group in partnership with Multicultural Health Services- MOMS program. The program offers support to CALD women after they having a baby.

They continue with the MOMS group for six sessions after which they will be referred to this project.

Several other group activities were organized for CALD families living in Newcastle and Lake Macquarie area, to provide community education and information. These sessions related to: Income Support, Centrelink/ Financial Support, Health, DV, Child Care, Settlement Information. A total of 178 individuals attended these sessions.

The project was promoted to Welfare Students at Glendale and Belmont TAFEs. The students comprised of Years 11 and 12 high school students from about 8 different schools. The presentation was part of their CERT II in Community Services /Children Services. A similar presentation was given to 9 Law Practitioners from Family Relationship and Interrelate Centre.

Community Capacity building

The project was also involved in organizing several major community events including this year's Harmony Day at Blackbutt; this was a joint event with members of the Newcastle Multicultural Interagency. Over a hundred people attended this fabulous 'Family Fun Day', with children enjoying story time activities and the adults enjoying a game of cricket. A Ranger from Blackbutt Reserve gave a talk to the families and many people took the opportunity to meet the very photogenic Mac, the Koala, before enjoying a BBQ lunch and African food prepared by the Burundi Ladies Group. The event was also enhanced by Family In Sight, Home Start, TAFE and Carylina.

Other events the project was involved with include: International Women's Day with the Hunter Women's Centre, Multicultural Services Expo at the Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre(MNC), Early Childhood Intervention Expo, Centrelink MSO morning tea for Japanese families living in the local area during Family week, , the White Ribbon Breakfast - International Day for the Elimination of Violence Against Women and the Refugee Week 2011 event – "Yarramundi Kids Puppet Show" . The last event was well attended by 300 children, with the content & the puppets being very well received. This event was organised by the Hunter Refugee Support Network along with other members including NSS, MA, CENTRELINK, MNC, Penola House. Events were well publicised through local print media (The Herald and The Post). All events were a great success.

Training

This year, I attended a number of training opportunities. This included participation in a Family Law Conference, the International Mental Health Conference, Keep Them Safe Training, PPP Development Training Day and a Seminar organized by the Centre for Parenting and Research by NSW Community Services.

Meetings / Committees

Meetings included: Newcastle Migrant Interagency, the Hunter Refugee Support Network, Lake Macquarie Interagency, Newcastle Interagency, Families NSW Network, Community Services' Hunter Central Coast Advisory Group, Hunter New England's Mental Health Multicultural Access Committee and Centrelink's Hunter Multicultural Forum, Early Childhood Intervention Coordination Program- Hunter Area Committee, Hunter Women's Domestic Violence Advocacy Service, Family In Sight and the Multicultural Advisory Health Committee

I would like to send my best 'retirement' wishes to our former CEO Violetta Walsh, congratulate Lulu on her appointment to the head of the agency & thank the NSS Board & my colleagues for their continued support of the CALD Family Project.



Thai Welfare Project

Nellie Srisurapon

Funded by NSW Community Services

This project provided support services to highly disadvantaged Thai people, mainly women and children who were experiencing hardship such as homelessness, mental health, isolation, physical & psychological crisis due to domestic violence, immigration issues, and other barriers detrimental to their settlement.

Working for 2 days per week, I provided casework, advocacy and referrals for the Thai community throughout the Hunter and some outreach to Central Coast.

This year, there are nearly 200 Thai families in the mailing list who were sent information regarding services providers available for the community, announcements on upcoming events, group sessions, etc. in the Thai language.

Casework kept me busy throughout the year with clients having complex and multiple issues and problems. The following table shows issues/needs and services provided:

Issues/Needs	Face to Face	Telephone	Group work sessions	No. of individuals attending
Immigration & Citizenship	36	106		
Education & Training	12	44		
Housing & Accommodation	26	82		
Employment	9	31		
Income Support & Finance	27	56		
Mental Health	14	68		
Domestic Violence	51	173		
Police	4	33		
Legal	37	129		
Family Problems	17	76	2	33
Health	12	46	2	36
Settlement Information	32	78	3	27
Home Visit/Outreach	58			
Form Filling	32			
Emails		311		
Total	367	1,233	7	96

There were 802 mail outs and 32 referrals to other service providers such as TAFE, GPs, women's & children's refuges, Family Support services, community housing, Community Mental Health, legal practitioners, police, Centrelink, DVCAS, and Department of Housing.

In partnership with Hunter Health Multicultural Unit, information sessions were organised for Thai women held at Edgeworth Community Centre such as domestic violence, women's health, medication and parenting skills. The group sessions also served as an avenue for Thai new arrivals to meet new friends.

Trainings, Meetings, Conferences, Sessions attended:

- Occupational Health & Safety
- Rent It Keep It
- Law for Non-Lawyers
- NSS Training with Shivani
- Grief & Trauma
- Car Child Seat Restraint Training
- NSS Caseworkers meeting
- Centrelink Multicultural Forum
- Central Coast DV Committee meetings
- Case Conferences
- Multicultural Expo 2010 at Erina
- International Women's Day (Central Coast)

Highlights:

- My presentation on the use of interpreters to CC service providers
- Thai Buddhist Ceremony (Edgeworth) Approximately 150 attendees
- Interview by students re: Hunter Region CALD issues
- Presentation on NSS to TAFE students from Gosford & Wyong
- Thai King's Birthday Celebration (Gregson Park) approximately 400 attendees (below)
- Eight women left family violence abuse and looking to a brighter future



Above:

Violetta giving Alms to Monks

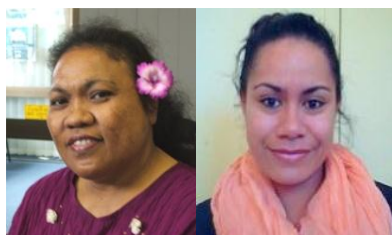
International Women's Day

Opening ceremony at Gregson Pk

Once again, it has been a challenging year. From mid August 2011, I will move to the position of NSS's Settlement Grants Program worker based at the Central Coast office. Therefore this is my last report for the Thai Project, which will also coincide with changes from the Community Services funding (EIPP).

Thank you for the support of the Welfare Team over the years and especially to Pet Kelly, the Welfare Team Leader. I will miss our Multicultural lunches!

Much appreciation to the Admin Team for all those flyers you folded and posted. Also, special thanks to Violetta Walsh, Lulu Tantos and Alex Burns for your support and guidance over the many years with the project.



Pacific Islander Welfare Project

Juanita Purcell-Loli (Samoan Welfare)

Finau Manu (Tongan Welfare)

Funded by NSW Community Services

The Pacific Islanders Welfare Project aims to assist disadvantaged Pacific Islanders, Culturally and Linguistically Diverse (CALD) clients with issues relating to:

- Accommodation & Housing
- Domestic Violence
- Employment
- Health/Mental Health
- Immigration & Citizenship
- Legal
- Youth Problems
- Income Support & Finances

The two workers aim to achieve the following objectives:

1. Supporting children, young people, individual and families of Pacific Islanders and clients of low income earners to enable the enhancement of their independence, safety, self-esteem and or quality of life within the communities by:
 - i) providing information, advice, referrals and advocacy to individuals and families.
 - ii) providing group work to the Pacific Island Women's Groups attended by 10 – 20 women.
 - iii) providing tax assistance through Tax Help Volunteer Programs (ATO)
 - iv) providing ongoing support, advocacy and casework to client group through case plan.
2. Building strong communities and social capital / undertaking community development so Pacific Island Communities are well informed, resourced, and connected and that equity and diversity are embraced by:
 - i) providing information via the newsletters distributed monthly to the Samoans and bi-monthly to the Tongans. This information includes family activities in the areas the Pacific Islanders live and information regarding changes to government policies etc. The purpose being to inform Pacific Islanders to enhance awareness of relevant services they can access. Information is also transmitted on a weekly basis to the Samoan and Tongan Communities via the Community Radio programs on Radio 2NURFM 103.7 (Sunday nights for the Samoans & Friday nights for the Tongans) and is heard by an audience of 300 – 400+
 - ii) Workers network with government and non-government agencies and service providers by attending meetings throughout the year for awareness and development. These include: Centrelink, Department of Housing, Community Services, Ethnic Communities Council, Hunter Tenants' Advice/Advocacy Service, Legal Aid, Migrant Health Services, Police Departments Newcastle & Central Coast, etc, and attend NSS Caseworkers' Meetings, NSS Staff days, Centrelink Multicultural Forum, CALD CS Advisory Group.

Another service provided to NSS clients is assessing their need for emergency relief or welfare assistance in paying bills through the EAPA Program on their electricity, gas and water. Clients who visit the office to obtain assistance with Tax Returns and Welfare Emergency Relief are not all of Pacific Islanders background, but are either Anglo- Saxons with low income or Centrelink recipients as well as CALD. They are either self-referred or referred by other service providers / or centre based referrals. The Tongan Welfare Worker is available at NSS 2 days a week.

Highlight

In March this year, in partnership with Callaghan College (Waratah Campus) we had the opportunity to organise a Cultural Dance Group. The group aims to help young multicultural students develop knowledge, understanding and skills about dance as an art form. It also aims to develop in them an appreciation of dance and as a means of describing and analysing dance as an expression of ideas within social, cultural or historical context. The group consists of Africans, Samoans, PNGs and Tongans.

ISSUES / PROBLEMS	Face to Face	Telephone Calls	Follow Up
Accommodation / Housing Issues	31	125	15
Centrelink Assistance & Referral	8	37	5
Child Protection Issues Domestic Violence / Advocacy	34	102	
Education / Training Assistance & information	4	3	
Employment <i>ie Resume Writing / Character References</i>	30	43	
Health Issues Health Related Matters	9	13	
Immigration Matters: Referrals / Sponsorships / Passport Applications / Renewals	37	63	3 enquiries referred 4 clients referred
Income Support – EAPA (Welfare / Emergency Relief)	361	60	
Justice of the Peace Document Verification	61	13	
Legal / Youth Issues Community (ie Parents) issues	24	111	5
Tax Returns (Tax Help Program)	136	40	10 F/U

It has been a productive and busy year for us though challenging with new clients other than Pacific Islanders referred from other workers. We appreciate the encouragement given by our Team Leader and the assistance by the Admin staff.

We are also grateful to our CEO and Operations Manager for the advice and guidance as well as their support in fulfilling our roles in the work we do for NSS. God bless you all and may you all have a happy and safe Christmas Break.



Russian Welfare Project

Elena Ferguson

Funded by NSW Community Services

This project provides support services to disadvantaged Russian speaking people, mainly women and children who are experiencing immigration issues, social isolation, language problems, and difficulties in finding a job and therefore stress and frustration which creates barriers for their integration into their new country.

The Russian Welfare Worker is available at NSS for 7 hours each week.

This report covers the last financial year. The Project had approximately 400 occasions of service including face to face, over the phone and through email contacts.

Tab.1 Issues Presented



The table above indicates a predominance of clients seeking information about community development and cultural information (**107**); help with family problems, including social/emotional support, issues with domestic violence and counseling (**84**), this resulted in isolation due to the distance from home and the clash of cultures within their own household and community. Other areas of support include:- immigration/citizenship/Russian passport issues (**60**); also completing forms and help with translations were required during the year (**40**). In addition, assistance was given with education, learning English and overseas qualification issues (**38**); plus, employment (**17**), doctor's appointments/health (**3**) and legal advice (**2**) were problems presented during the year.

To provide community education and to raise awareness of health issues two information sessions on Women's Health for Russian speaking women were organised in a partnership with Hunter New England Multicultural Health during the year. Also organized, were three educational sessions on topics identified by the target Russian groups such as, "Parenting Skills" (craft, sewing), "Relationships Between Family Members" and the "Sun and its Effect on Your Health". In addition, a Cooking Class and regular Russian Language School for children were held during the year with a minimum of 13 students attended each session.

The Russian language Newsletter "Berezka" was issued 4 times during the year to 102 Russian-speaking families with information on community meetings, gatherings, announcements, welfare services availability, and other cultural and linguistic materials. Likewise, brochures in the Russian language were sent on issues such as Australian laws, women's health, Centrelink, etc. providing settlement information for new arrivals.

Other Activities:

Throughout the year, I helped organized the following:

Cultural events, celebrations and social gatherings (4) such as: the Annual Celebration of International Women's Day (**35** women attendees); Family Easter Picnic with sport activities (**39** people attended); a Community gathering with children's performances, cultural games, songs and dances (**57** people participated); the Russian New Year Family Party with Russian Santa Claus, games and dancing (**100** people involved); also, the Harmony Day Celebrations (Singleton and Cessnock), were held as a part of NSS promotion and the Russian Women's Group representation with a performance of Russian songs, crafts and traditional costumes.

To build and maintain the community service systems networks, to promote best practice, improve the level of information exchange and service coordination the following meetings were attended during the year:

Case workers meetings NSS (7)

Staff Training Day NSS (2)

NSS AGM

White Ribbon Day/Violence Against Women Breakfast

Child Protection Day Breakfast

NSS OH&S Training

Training completed:

-Vital Hepatitis and HIV/AIDS

-Safe Food Handling

-Divorce Classess

-Child Seat Restraints Fitting

-Children: Crisis, Trauma and Grief

-Harmony Day Celebration (Singleton, Cessnock)

-International Women's Day Celebration

The highlight of my year has been the completion of my **Bachelor Degree in Social Science**; this has enhanced my understanding of my job and gives me a better insight into what is required and what can be achieved in the day to day operations of the NSS.

I wish to thank my colleagues and the NSS Board for their on-going support.

FINANCE & ADMINISTRATION TEAM Newcastle & Central Coast (CC)



Arlene Richards
Financial Controller
(Left Oct 2010)



Marianne Mohr
Assistant Financial Controller



Wendy Kirkham
Finance Assistant
Administration Officer



Mary Milevski
Acting Operations
Manager



Silvia Ruano-McLerie
Senior Administration Officer
(Left Oct 2010)



Helen Short
Administration Officer
(Left July 2011)



Lydia Manusiu
Administration Officer



Jacinta Boidin
Administration Trainee



Helen Buchanan
OH&S Consultant



Trudy Wahl
Office Manager -CC
(Left Nov 2010)



Julie Styles
Administration Assistant-CC
(Left June 2010)

CENTRE USAGE 2010-2011

Broadband for Seniors	Multicultural Women's Group
Brighter Futures Coordinators	United Boys Dance
Ba'hai Community of Newcastle	Multicultural Dementia Careers Group
NSS Case Workers	Multicultural Respite Group
NSS Child Restraint Training	Newcastle Multicultural Interagency
DOCS CALD funded workers	MAP Advisory Committee
DIAC Outreach Session	Nina Dance Group
Centrelink Multicultural Forum	Newcastle & Hunter Ethnic Choral Soc.
Congolese Community	NSS Board of Management
DIAC Immigration Officers	PCG Church
Estonian Community of Newcastle	Russian Women's Group
Filipino Community Choir	Russian School
Filipino Women's Group	Refugee Council
Greek Macedonian Brotherhood	Refugee Week Organising Committee
Hunter Refugee Network	Samoan Women's Group
Hunter Community Legal Clinic	Family Relationships
Migrant Interagency	Tamil Language School
International Singers	Tongan Choir
SIDS for Kids Info Session	Sudanese Youth
Latin Ladies Group	Hamilton Walking Group
Local School Agency Visit	NSS Volunteer Registration
Hunter Dementia Support	Hunter CALD Group
Homework Centre Co-ordinators	HMRS Carers
Refugee Council of Australia	CVS Volunteers
Harmony Day Planning Committee	Thai Women's Group
REAL D Program	NSS IT Training
Latvian Group	United Nations Association Australia



Awards & Recognition



NSS's **Stay Safe at the Beach** event received the 2011 NSW Water Safety Award for the Water Safety Event of the Year



NSS worked together with other agencies on the **2011 Refugee Week** events through the facilitation of the Hunter Refugee Support Network



The NSS sponsors the **TAFE Cultural Diversity Award** –was awarded to Resma Lal Dumre, by our CEO Lulu Tantos



NSS was one of the partners in the work of the **The Real D** program, which connects African youth (12-24years) to opportunities within the community & to support lifelong learning, education, training & employment.

*Our
Volunteer Appreciation
Morning Tea*

NSS greatly values the work of our volunteers
& acknowledged their contribution to the
various NSS programs during
National Volunteer Week
(May 2011)



People helping people...



NSS CEO Lulu Tantos presenting an
award to an NSS volunteer



Clients share how Volunteers make
a difference to their lives



MAP Coordinator Val Woodman with
our 'Broadband for Seniors'
Volunteer Tutors



Our board members Christine
Jordan & Sania Young show their
support for our volunteers
& NSS programs

refugee week june 20-26 2011

Yarramundi Kids

PUPPET SHOW

Attended by 300 children, this event was organised by Hunter Refugee Network (convened & facilitated by NSS) for Refugee Week in support of theme 'Freedom from Fear'



*Freedom
from
Fear*

Farewell

our best wishes to...



Violetta J Walsh OAM

Chief Executive Officer

Years of service: 1984 - 2011

Northern Settlement Services